EXERCISE 8

General Solution and Phase Portrait from Eigenvalues and Eigenvectors

Original statement · probls_ch4-i_2627_v2.pdf, p. 2

Eigen-data • Nodes and Saddles • Eight Portraits

STATEMENT

Write down the general solution and draw the phase portrait for the equation $\dot{\mathbf{x}} = A\mathbf{x}$, when the eigenvalues and eigenvectors of A are as given in each case. You should take particular care with stable (or unstable) nodes to ensure that the trajectories approach (or move away from) the origin tangent to the correct eigenvector.

- (i) $\lambda_1 = 1, \mathbf{v}_1 = (1, 1)$ and $\lambda_2 = 2, \mathbf{v}_2 = (1, -1)$;
- (ii) $\lambda_1 = 1, \mathbf{v}_1 = (1, 0)$ and $\lambda_2 = -2, \mathbf{v}_2 = (1, 1)$;
- (iii) $\lambda_1 = -2, \mathbf{v}_1 = (1, 2)$ and $\lambda_2 = -3, \mathbf{v}_2 = (2, -3)$;
- (iv) $\lambda_1 = 3, \mathbf{v}_1 = (2, 3)$ and $\lambda_2 = -5, \mathbf{v}_2 = (0, 1)$;
- (v) $\lambda_1 = 3, \mathbf{v}_1 = (1, 2)$ and $\lambda_2 = 1, \mathbf{v}_2 = (1, -3)$;
- (vi) $\lambda_1 = 2, \mathbf{v}_1 = (0, 1)$ and $\lambda_2 = -3, \mathbf{v}_2 = (1, 5)$;
- (vii) $\lambda_1 = 1, \mathbf{v}_1 = (1, 1)$ and $\lambda_2 = 2, \mathbf{v}_2 = (2, 1)$;
- (viii) $\lambda_1 = -3, \mathbf{v}_1 = (1, 3)$ and $\lambda_2 = -1, \mathbf{v}_2 = (-3, 2)$;

PHASE 1: SETUP AND CLASSIFICATION

In every item the two eigenvalues are real and distinct, with linearly independent eigenvectors (so $\det[\mathbf{v}_1\ \mathbf{v}_2] \neq 0$, checked in each item). The general solution is then $\mathbf{x} = c_1 e^{\lambda_1 t}\mathbf{v}_1 + c_2 e^{\lambda_2 t}\mathbf{v}_2$ (Robinson Eq. 28.1) and the portrait is determined by the signs of λ_1, λ_2 (Topic 4 Sec. 6 and 9):

Signs	Origin	Behaviour
$\lambda_1, \lambda_2 < 0$	stable node	all orbits tend to $\mathbf{0}$, tangent to the eigenvector of the smaller $\lvert\lambda\rvert$
$\lambda_1, \lambda_2 > 0$	unstable node	all orbits leave $\mathbf{0}$, tangent to the eigenvector of the smaller $\lvert\lambda\rvert$
$\lambda_1\lambda_2 < 0$	saddle	only the orbits on the stable eigenline reach $\mathbf{0}$

Item	λ_1, λ_2	Type	Slow direction (smaller $\lvert\lambda\rvert$)
(i)	$1, 2$	unstable node	$\mathbf{v}_1 = (1, 1)$
(ii)	$1, -2$	saddle	not applicable
(iii)	$-2, -3$	stable node	$\mathbf{v}_1 = (1, 2)$
(iv)	$3, -5$	saddle	not applicable
(v)	$3, 1$	unstable node	$\mathbf{v}_2 = (1, -3)$
(vi)	$2, -3$	saddle	not applicable
(vii)	$1, 2$	unstable node	$\mathbf{v}_1 = (1, 1)$
(viii)	$-3, -1$	stable node	$\mathbf{v}_2 = (-3, 2)$

PHASE 2: FORMULATION: HOW EACH ITEM IS TREATED

For each item: (1) the general solution; (2) the matrix $A = Q\Lambda Q^{-1}$ reconstructed from the data, used to draw and to check; (3) the canonical system $\dot{\mathbf{z}} = \Lambda\mathbf{z}$ with $\mathbf{z} = Q^{-1}\mathbf{x}$ and its solution; (4) the portrait in the $\mathbf{z}$-plane and its image under $\mathbf{x} = Q\mathbf{z}$ in the (x, y)-plane, with the arrows and the tangent direction decided by the rules above.

PHASE 3: DERIVATION OF THE EIGHT PORTRAITS

(i) $\lambda_1 = 1,\ \mathbf{v}_1 = (1,1)^T;\ \lambda_2 = 2,\ \mathbf{v}_2 = (1,-1)^T$

The statement gives the eigen-data, not the matrix. Since $A\mathbf{v}_j = \lambda_j\mathbf{v}_j$ for $j = 1, 2$ means $AQ = Q\Lambda$ with $Q = [\mathbf{v}_1 \mid \mathbf{v}_2]$, the matrix is $A = Q\Lambda Q^{-1}$ (it is needed to draw the portrait and to check the data):

$$Q = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad \Lambda = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 2 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad \det Q = -2, \qquad Q^{-1} = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{1}{2} & \frac{1}{2} \\ \frac{1}{2} & -\frac{1}{2} \end{pmatrix}$$

$$\begin{aligned} (Q\Lambda)_{11} &= 1 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 0 = 1 \\ (Q\Lambda)_{12} &= 1 \cdot 0 + 1 \cdot 2 = 2 \\ (Q\Lambda)_{21} &= 1 \cdot 1 + (-1) \cdot 0 = 1 \\ (Q\Lambda)_{22} &= 1 \cdot 0 + (-1) \cdot 2 = -2 \end{aligned}$$

$$Q\Lambda = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 1 & -2 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$
\begin{aligned}
(A)_{11} &= 1 \cdot \frac{1}{2} + 2 \cdot \frac{1}{2} = \frac{3}{2} \\
(A)_{12} &= 1 \cdot \frac{1}{2} + 2 \cdot (-\frac{1}{2}) = -\frac{1}{2} \\
(A)_{21} &= 1 \cdot \frac{1}{2} + (-2) \cdot \frac{1}{2} = -\frac{1}{2} \\
(A)_{22} &= 1 \cdot \frac{1}{2} + (-2) \cdot (-\frac{1}{2}) = \frac{3}{2}
\end{aligned}
$$

$$
A = Q \Lambda Q^{-1} = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{3}{2} & -\frac{1}{2} \\ -\frac{1}{2} & \frac{3}{2} \end{pmatrix}
$$

Change of coordinates

The eigenvectors of distinct eigenvalues are linearly independent (Topic 4, Appendix B argument), so they form a basis. Put them as columns, $Q = [\mathbf{v}_1 \mid \mathbf{v}_2]$, and define the new coordinates by $\mathbf{z} = Q^{-1}\mathbf{x}$, i.e. $\mathbf{x} = Q\mathbf{z}$:

$$
Q = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{pmatrix}
$$

$\det Q = (1)(-1) - (1)(1) = -2$, which is not zero, so Q is invertible. For a 2×2 matrix $\begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix}^{-1} = \frac{1}{ad-bc}\begin{pmatrix} d & -b \\ -c & a \end{pmatrix}$ (Robinson, Appendix B):

$$
Q^{-1} = \frac{1}{-2}\begin{pmatrix} -1 & -1 \\ -1 & 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{1}{2} & \frac{1}{2} \\ \frac{1}{2} & -\frac{1}{2} \end{pmatrix}
$$

Since Q is constant, $\dot{\mathbf{z}} = Q^{-1}\dot{\mathbf{x}} = Q^{-1}A\mathbf{x} = (Q^{-1}AQ)\mathbf{z}$. Compute AQ one column at a time, with $A\mathbf{v}_j = \lambda_j \mathbf{v}_j$:

$$
A\mathbf{v}_1 = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{3}{2} & -\frac{1}{2} \\ -\frac{1}{2} & \frac{3}{2} \end{pmatrix}\begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} = 1\mathbf{v}_1, \qquad A\mathbf{v}_2 = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{3}{2} & -\frac{1}{2} \\ -\frac{1}{2} & \frac{3}{2} \end{pmatrix}\begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ -1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ -2 \end{pmatrix} = 2\mathbf{v}_2
$$

$$
AQ = [A\mathbf{v}_1 \mid A\mathbf{v}_2] = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 1 & -2 \end{pmatrix}
$$

Now multiply by Q^{-1} on the left, entry by entry:

$$(Q^{-1}AQ)_{11} = \frac{1}{2}\cdot 1 + \frac{1}{2}\cdot 1 = 1$$
$$(Q^{-1}AQ)_{12} = \frac{1}{2}\cdot 2 + \frac{1}{2}\cdot (-2) = 0$$
$$(Q^{-1}AQ)_{21} = \frac{1}{2}\cdot 1 + (-\frac{1}{2})\cdot 1 = 0$$
$$(Q^{-1}AQ)_{22} = \frac{1}{2}\cdot 2 + (-\frac{1}{2})\cdot (-2) = 2$$

$$Q^{-1}AQ = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 2 \end{pmatrix} = \Lambda = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 2 \end{pmatrix}$$

The transformation has decoupled the system (the matrix is diagonal), as claimed.

Solution in the canonical plane

$$\dot{z}_1 = z_1, \qquad \dot{z}_2 = 2z_2$$

Each equation is separable. If $z_i \neq 0$, $\frac{dz_i}{z_i} = \lambda_i\, dt$ and integrating, $\ln|z_i| = \lambda_i t + C_i$, so $z_i = c_i e^{\lambda_i t}$ with $c_i = \pm e^{C_i}$ (the solution $z_i \equiv 0$ corresponds to $c_i = 0$). Equivalently, $\frac{d}{dt}(e^{-\lambda_i t} z_i) = 0$.

$$z_1(t) = c_1 e^{1t}, \qquad z_2(t) = c_2 e^{2t}$$

Back to the original coordinates

$\mathbf{x} = Q\mathbf{z} = z_1\mathbf{v}_1 + z_2\mathbf{v}_2$, so the general solution is

$$\mathbf{x}(t) = c_1 e^{1t}\begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} + c_2 e^{2t}\begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ -1 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$x(t) = c_1 e^{t} + c_2 e^{2t}, \qquad y(t) = c_1 e^{t} - c_2 e^{2t}$$

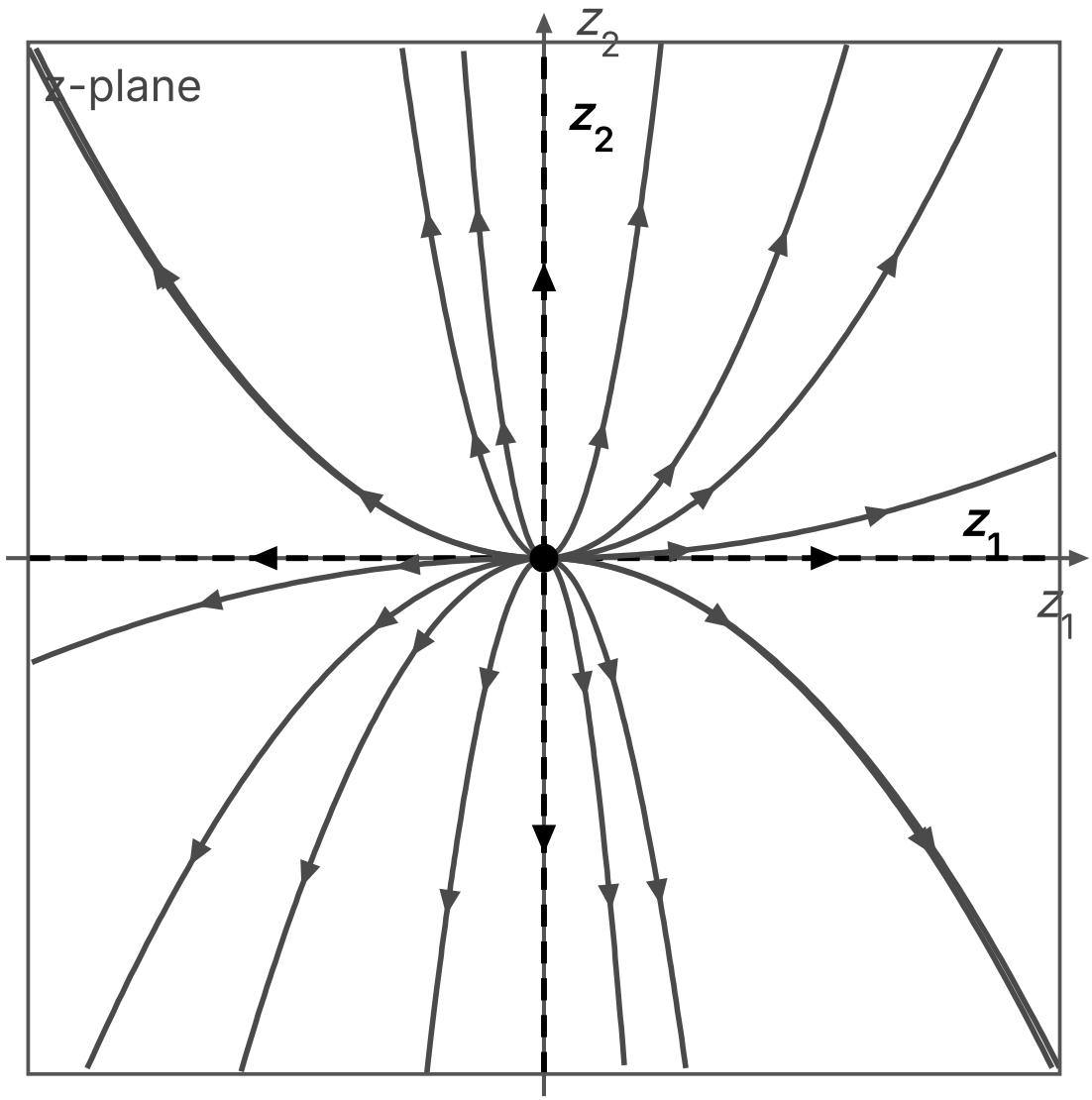
Phase portrait

$\lambda_1 = 1$ and $\lambda_2 = 2$ are both positive: the origin is a **unstable node** (Robinson Ch. 28, Topic 4 Sec. 6 and 9).

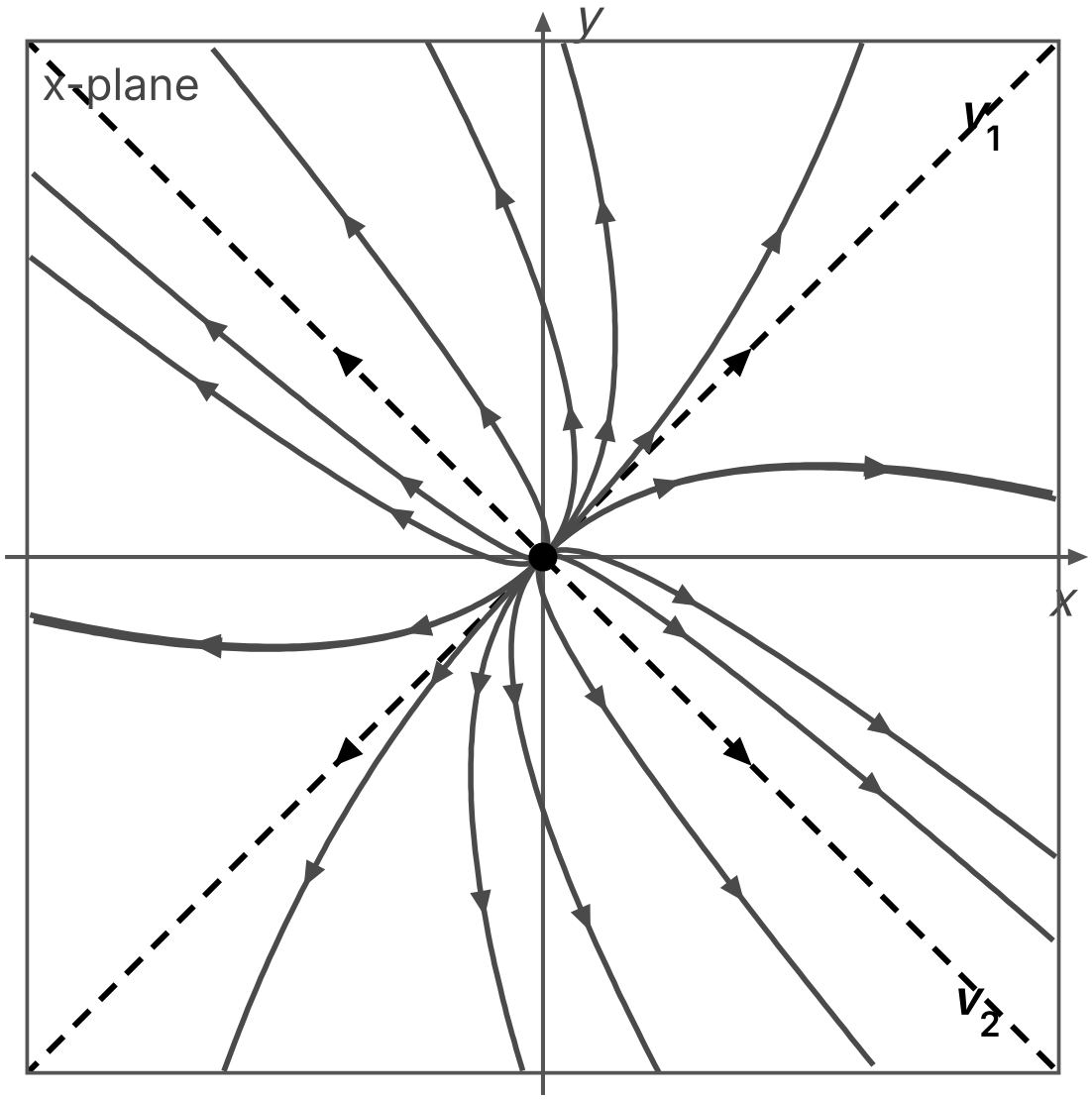
In the canonical $\mathbf{z}$-plane, eliminating t from $z_1 = c_1 e^{1t}$ and $z_2 = c_2 e^{2t}$ (for $c_1 \neq 0$): $|z_1|/|c_1| = e^{\lambda_1 t}$, so $e^t = (|z_1|/|c_1|)^{1/\lambda_1}$ and $|z_2| = |c_2| e^{\lambda_2 t} = |c_2|\,(|z_1|/|c_1|)^{\lambda_2/\lambda_1}$, i.e. $z_2 = K\,|z_1|^{\lambda_2/\lambda_1} = K\,|z_1|^2$ with $K = c_2 |c_1|^{-\lambda_2/\lambda_1}$ (equivalently, integrate the separable equation $\frac{dz_2}{dz_1} = \frac{\lambda_2 z_2}{\lambda_1 z_1}$ by the chain rule, as in Exercise 10). The axes $z_1 = 0$ and $z_2 = 0$ are invariant: a solution that starts on an axis stays on it.

The exponent $\lambda_2/\lambda_1 = 2$ is positive, so the orbits are parabola-like curves through the origin. At the origin they are tangent to the eigenvector of the eigenvalue of **smaller modulus**, $|\lambda| = 1$, i.e. to the line through $(1, 1)$ (they leave from there (the limit $t \to -\infty$)), and far from the origin they become parallel to the other eigenvector (the fast direction). The arrows point away from the origin on both eigenlines.

The map $\mathbf{x} = Q\mathbf{z}$ sends the z_1-axis to the line through $\mathbf{v}_1 = (1, 1)$ and the z_2-axis to the line through $\mathbf{v}_2 = (1, -1)$. Straight lines stay straight and the origin stays fixed, so the $\mathbf{x}$-portrait is the canonical one sheared onto the eigenlines. On $\mathbf{v}_1$: $\dot{\mathbf{x}} = A\mathbf{v}_1 = 1\mathbf{v}_1$ points outward; on $\mathbf{v}_2$: $\dot{\mathbf{x}} = 2\mathbf{v}_2$ points outward.



Canonical $\mathbf{z}$-plane (unstable node): invariant axes and orbits $z_2 = K|z_1|^2$.



Original (x, y)-plane (unstable node): dashed lines are the eigenlines $\mathbf{v}_1 = (1, 1)$ and $\mathbf{v}_2 = (1, -1)$.

(ii) $\lambda_1 = 1$, $\mathbf{v}_1 = (1, 0)^T$; $\lambda_2 = -2$, $\mathbf{v}_2 = (1, 1)^T$

The statement gives the eigen-data, not the matrix. Since $A\mathbf{v}_j = \lambda_j \mathbf{v}_j$ for $j = 1, 2$ means $AQ = Q\Lambda$ with $Q = [\mathbf{v}_1 \mid \mathbf{v}_2]$, the matrix is $A = Q\Lambda Q^{-1}$ (it is needed to draw the portrait and to check the data):

$$Q = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad \Lambda = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & -2 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad \det Q = 1, \qquad Q^{-1} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & -1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$
\begin{aligned}
(Q\Lambda)_{11} &= 1\cdot 1 + 1\cdot 0 = 1\\
(Q\Lambda)_{12} &= 1\cdot 0 + 1\cdot (-2) = -2\\
(Q\Lambda)_{21} &= 0\cdot 1 + 1\cdot 0 = 0\\
(Q\Lambda)_{22} &= 0\cdot 0 + 1\cdot (-2) = -2
\end{aligned}
$$

$$
Q\Lambda = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & -2 \\ 0 & -2 \end{pmatrix}
$$

$$
\begin{aligned}
(A)_{11} &= 1\cdot 1 + (-2)\cdot 0 = 1\\
(A)_{12} &= 1\cdot (-1) + (-2)\cdot 1 = -3\\
(A)_{21} &= 0\cdot 1 + (-2)\cdot 0 = 0\\
(A)_{22} &= 0\cdot (-1) + (-2)\cdot 1 = -2
\end{aligned}
$$

$$
A = Q\Lambda Q^{-1} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & -3 \\ 0 & -2 \end{pmatrix}
$$

Change of coordinates

The eigenvectors of distinct eigenvalues are linearly independent (Topic 4, Appendix B argument), so they form a basis. Put them as columns, $Q = [\mathbf{v}_1 \mid \mathbf{v}_2]$, and define the new coordinates by $\mathbf{z} = Q^{-1}\mathbf{x}$, i.e. $\mathbf{x} = Q\mathbf{z}$:

$$
Q = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}
$$

$\det Q = (1)(1) - (1)(0) = 1$, which is not zero, so Q is invertible. For a 2×2 matrix $\begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix}^{-1} = \frac{1}{ad-bc}\begin{pmatrix} d & -b \\ -c & a \end{pmatrix}$ (Robinson, Appendix B):

$$
Q^{-1} = \frac{1}{1}\begin{pmatrix} 1 & -1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & -1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}
$$

Since Q is constant, $\dot{\mathbf{z}} = Q^{-1}\dot{\mathbf{x}} = Q^{-1}A\mathbf{x} = (Q^{-1}AQ)\mathbf{z}$. Compute AQ one column at a time, with $A\mathbf{v}_j = \lambda_j \mathbf{v}_j$:

$$A\mathbf{v}_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & -3 \\ 0 & -2 \end{pmatrix}\begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} = 1\mathbf{v}_1, \qquad A\mathbf{v}_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & -3 \\ 0 & -2 \end{pmatrix}\begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} -2 \\ -2 \end{pmatrix} = (-2)\mathbf{v}_2$$

$$AQ = [A\mathbf{v}_1 \mid A\mathbf{v}_2] = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & -2 \\ 0 & -2 \end{pmatrix}$$

Now multiply by Q^{-1} on the left, entry by entry:

$$\begin{aligned} (Q^{-1}AQ)_{11} &= 1\cdot 1 + (-1)\cdot 0 = 1 \\ (Q^{-1}AQ)_{12} &= 1\cdot(-2) + (-1)\cdot(-2) = 0 \\ (Q^{-1}AQ)_{21} &= 0\cdot 1 + 1\cdot 0 = 0 \\ (Q^{-1}AQ)_{22} &= 0\cdot(-2) + 1\cdot(-2) = -2 \end{aligned}$$

$$Q^{-1}AQ = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & -2 \end{pmatrix} = \Lambda = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & -2 \end{pmatrix}$$

The transformation has decoupled the system (the matrix is diagonal), as claimed.

Solution in the canonical plane

$$\dot{z}_1 = z_1, \qquad \dot{z}_2 = -2z_2$$

Each equation is separable. If $z_i \neq 0$, $\frac{dz_i}{z_i} = \lambda_i\,dt$ and integrating, $\ln|z_i| = \lambda_i t + C_i$, so $z_i = c_i e^{\lambda_i t}$ with $c_i = \pm e^{C_i}$ (the solution $z_i \equiv 0$ corresponds to $c_i = 0$). Equivalently, $\frac{d}{dt}(e^{-\lambda_i t} z_i) = 0$.

$$z_1(t) = c_1 e^{1t}, \qquad z_2(t) = c_2 e^{-2t}$$

Back to the original coordinates

$\mathbf{x} = Q\mathbf{z} = z_1\mathbf{v}_1 + z_2\mathbf{v}_2$, so the general solution is

$$\mathbf{x}(t) = c_1 e^{1t}\begin{pmatrix}1\\0\end{pmatrix} + c_2 e^{-2t}\begin{pmatrix}1\\1\end{pmatrix}$$

$$x(t) = c_1 e^{t} + c_2 e^{-2t}, \qquad y(t) = c_2 e^{-2t}$$

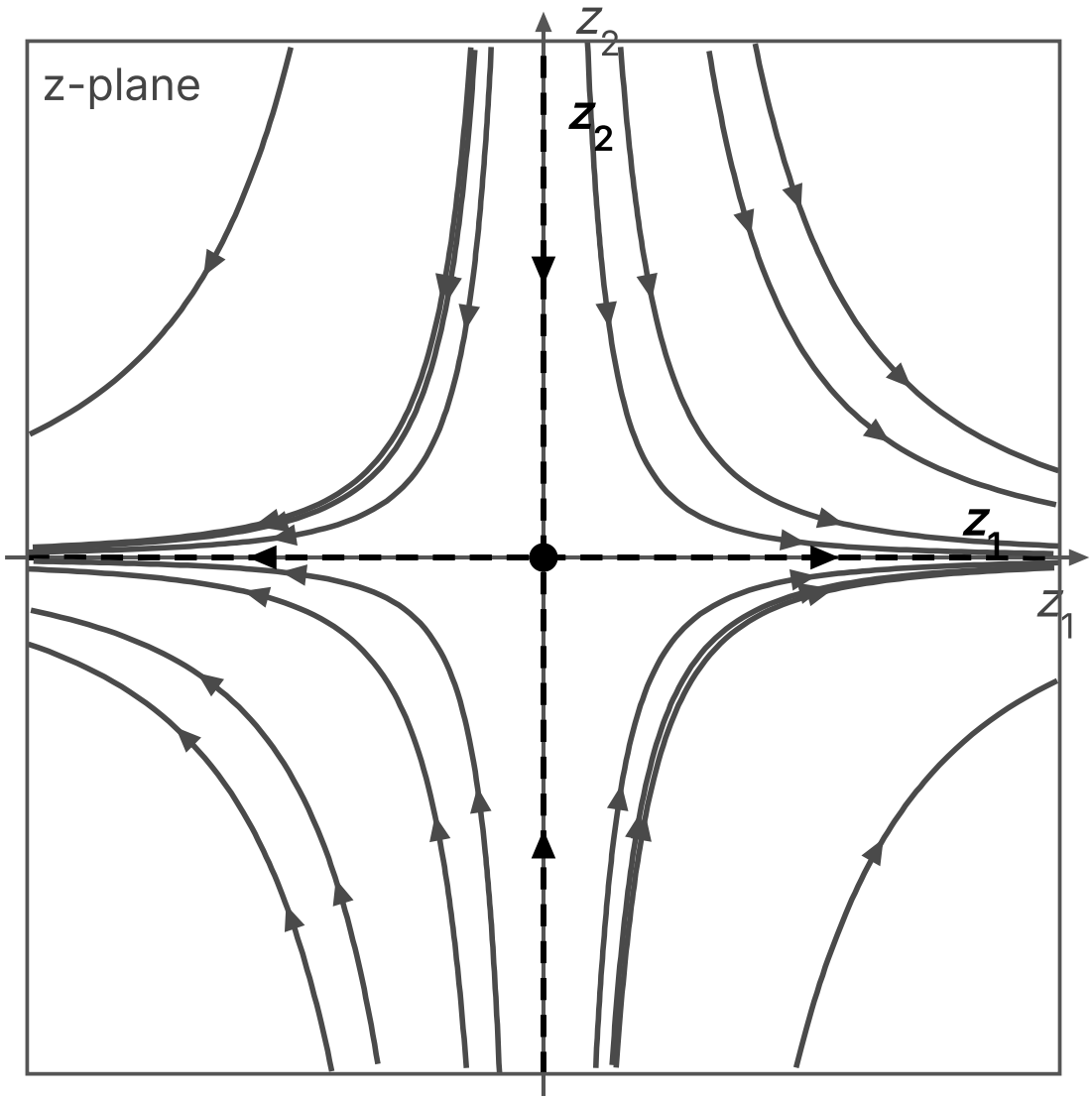
Phase portrait

$\lambda_1 = 1$ and $\lambda_2 = -2$ are of opposite signs: the origin is a **saddle** (Robinson Ch. 28, Topic 4 Sec. 6 and 9).

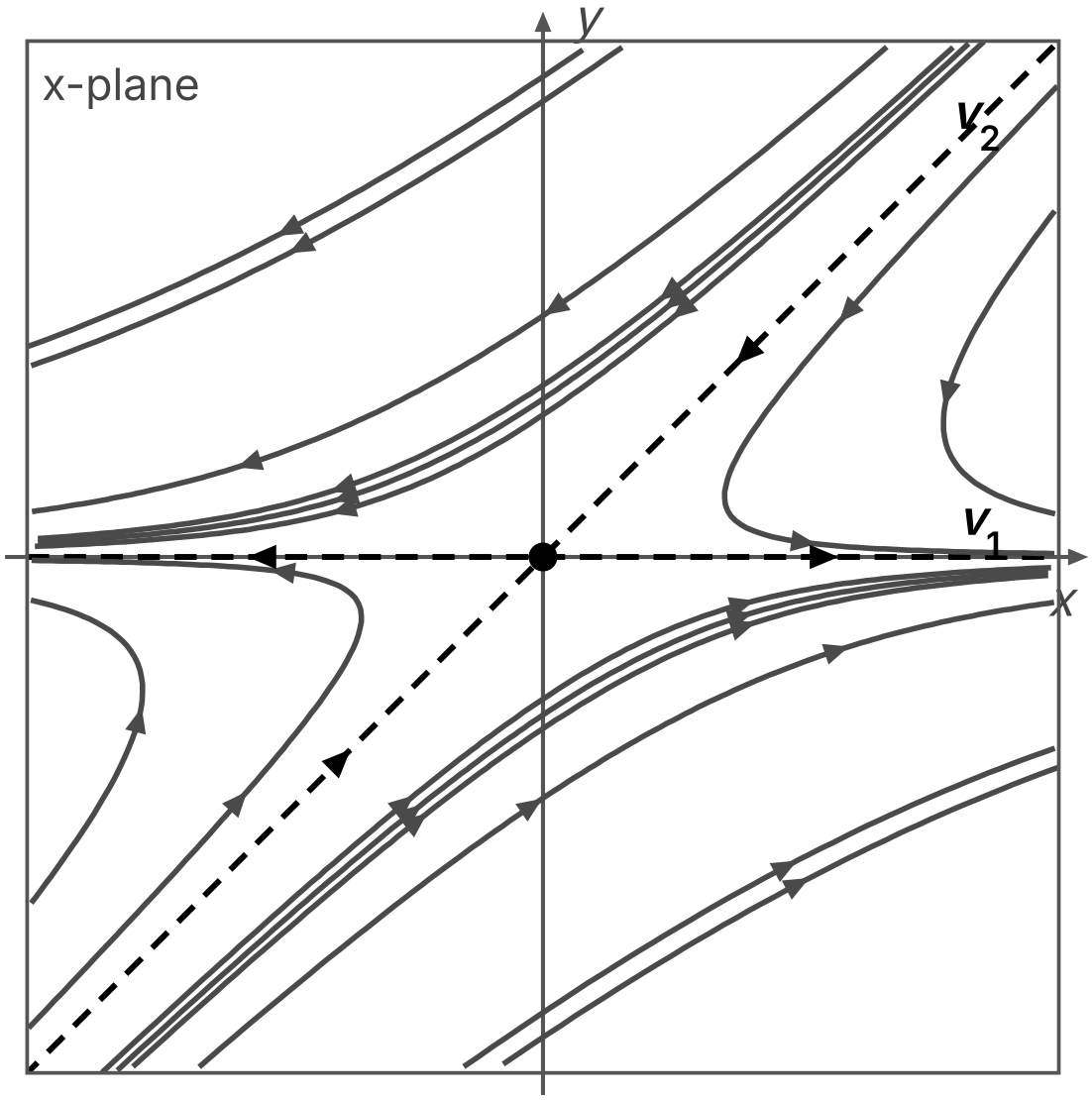
In the canonical $\mathbf{z}$-plane, eliminating t from $z_1 = c_1 e^{1t}$ and $z_2 = c_2 e^{-2t}$ (for $c_1 \neq 0$): $|z_1|/|c_1| = e^{\lambda_1 t}$, so $e^{t} = (|z_1|/|c_1|)^{1/\lambda_1}$ and $|z_2| = |c_2| e^{\lambda_2 t} = |c_2|\,(|z_1|/|c_1|)^{\lambda_2/\lambda_1}$, i.e. $z_2 = K\,|z_1|^{\lambda_2/\lambda_1} = K\,|z_1|^{-2}$ with $K = c_2 |c_1|^{-\lambda_2/\lambda_1}$ (equivalently, integrate the separable equation $\frac{dz_2}{dz_1} = \frac{\lambda_2 z_2}{\lambda_1 z_1}$ by the chain rule, as in Exercise 10). The axes $z_1 = 0$ and $z_2 = 0$ are invariant: a solution that starts on an axis stays on it.

The exponent $\lambda_2/\lambda_1 = -2$ is negative, so the orbits are hyperbola-like. Only solutions starting on the eigenline of the negative eigenvalue, the line through $(1, 1)$ (the **stable manifold**), reach the origin as $t \to +\infty$; the line through $(1, 0)$ (positive eigenvalue) is the **unstable manifold**. All other orbits come in close to the stable line, then leave along the unstable one.

The map $\mathbf{x} = Q\mathbf{z}$ sends the z_1-axis to the line through $\mathbf{v}_1 = (1, 0)$ and the z_2-axis to the line through $\mathbf{v}_2 = (1, 1)$. Straight lines stay straight and the origin stays fixed, so the $\mathbf{x}$-portrait is the canonical one sheared onto the eigenlines. On $\mathbf{v}_1$: $\dot{\mathbf{x}} = A\mathbf{v}_1 = 1\mathbf{v}_1$ points outward; on $\mathbf{v}_2$: $\dot{\mathbf{x}} = -2\mathbf{v}_2$ points inward.



Canonical $\mathbf{z}$-plane (saddle): invariant axes and orbits $z_2 = K|z_1|^{-2}$.



Original (x, y)-plane (saddle): dashed lines are the eigenlines $\mathbf{v}_1 = (1, 0)$ and $\mathbf{v}_2 = (1, 1)$.

(iii) $\lambda_1 = -2$, $\mathbf{v}_1 = (1, 2)^T$; $\lambda_2 = -3$, $\mathbf{v}_2 = (2, -3)^T$

The statement gives the eigen-data, not the matrix. Since $A\mathbf{v}_j = \lambda_j \mathbf{v}_j$ for $j = 1, 2$ means $AQ = Q\Lambda$ with $Q = [\mathbf{v}_1 \mid \mathbf{v}_2]$, the matrix is $A = Q\Lambda Q^{-1}$ (it is needed to draw the portrait and to check the data):

$$Q = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 2 & -3 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad \Lambda = \begin{pmatrix} -2 & 0 \\ 0 & -3 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad \det Q = -7, \qquad Q^{-1} = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{3}{7} & \frac{2}{7} \\ \frac{2}{7} & -\frac{1}{7} \end{pmatrix}$$

$$
\begin{aligned}
(Q\Lambda)_{11} &= 1\cdot(-2) + 2\cdot 0 = -2 \\
(Q\Lambda)_{12} &= 1\cdot 0 + 2\cdot(-3) = -6 \\
(Q\Lambda)_{21} &= 2\cdot(-2) + (-3)\cdot 0 = -4 \\
(Q\Lambda)_{22} &= 2\cdot 0 + (-3)\cdot(-3) = 9
\end{aligned}
$$

$$
Q\Lambda = \begin{pmatrix} -2 & -6 \\ -4 & 9 \end{pmatrix}
$$

$$
\begin{aligned}
(A)_{11} &= (-2)\cdot\frac{3}{7} + (-6)\cdot\frac{2}{7} = -\frac{18}{7} \\
(A)_{12} &= (-2)\cdot\frac{2}{7} + (-6)\cdot(-\frac{1}{7}) = \frac{2}{7} \\
(A)_{21} &= (-4)\cdot\frac{3}{7} + 9\cdot\frac{2}{7} = \frac{6}{7} \\
(A)_{22} &= (-4)\cdot\frac{2}{7} + 9\cdot(-\frac{1}{7}) = -\frac{17}{7}
\end{aligned}
$$

$$
A = Q\Lambda Q^{-1} = \begin{pmatrix} -\frac{18}{7} & \frac{2}{7} \\ \frac{6}{7} & -\frac{17}{7} \end{pmatrix}
$$

Change of coordinates

The eigenvectors of distinct eigenvalues are linearly independent (Topic 4, Appendix B argument), so they form a basis. Put them as columns, $Q = [\mathbf{v}_1 \mid \mathbf{v}_2]$, and define the new coordinates by $\mathbf{z} = Q^{-1}\mathbf{x}$, i.e. $\mathbf{x} = Q\mathbf{z}$:

$$
Q = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 2 & -3 \end{pmatrix}
$$

$\det Q = (1)(-3) - (2)(2) = -7$, which is not zero, so Q is invertible. For a 2×2 matrix $\begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix}^{-1} = \frac{1}{ad-bc}\begin{pmatrix} d & -b \\ -c & a \end{pmatrix}$ (Robinson, Appendix B):

$$
Q^{-1} = \frac{1}{-7}\begin{pmatrix} -3 & -2 \\ -2 & 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{3}{7} & \frac{2}{7} \\ \frac{2}{7} & -\frac{1}{7} \end{pmatrix}
$$

Since Q is constant, $\dot{\mathbf{z}} = Q^{-1}\dot{\mathbf{x}} = Q^{-1}A\mathbf{x} = (Q^{-1}AQ)\mathbf{z}$. Compute AQ one column at a time, with $A\mathbf{v}_j = \lambda_j\mathbf{v}_j$:

$$A\mathbf{v}_1 = \begin{pmatrix} -\frac{18}{7} & \frac{2}{7} \\ \frac{6}{7} & -\frac{17}{7} \end{pmatrix}\begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} -2 \\ -4 \end{pmatrix} = (-2)\mathbf{v}_1, \qquad A\mathbf{v}_2 = \begin{pmatrix} -\frac{18}{7} & \frac{2}{7} \\ \frac{6}{7} & -\frac{17}{7} \end{pmatrix}\begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ -3 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} -6 \\ 9 \end{pmatrix} = (-3)\mathbf{v}_2$$

$$AQ = [A\mathbf{v}_1 \mid A\mathbf{v}_2] = \begin{pmatrix} -2 & -6 \\ -4 & 9 \end{pmatrix}$$

Now multiply by Q^{-1} on the left, entry by entry:

$$\begin{aligned} (Q^{-1}AQ)_{11} &= \frac{3}{7}\cdot(-2) + \frac{2}{7}\cdot(-4) = -2 \\ (Q^{-1}AQ)_{12} &= \frac{3}{7}\cdot(-6) + \frac{2}{7}\cdot 9 = 0 \\ (Q^{-1}AQ)_{21} &= \frac{2}{7}\cdot(-2) + (-\frac{1}{7})\cdot(-4) = 0 \\ (Q^{-1}AQ)_{22} &= \frac{2}{7}\cdot(-6) + (-\frac{1}{7})\cdot 9 = -3 \end{aligned}$$

$$Q^{-1}AQ = \begin{pmatrix} -2 & 0 \\ 0 & -3 \end{pmatrix} = \Lambda = \begin{pmatrix} -2 & 0 \\ 0 & -3 \end{pmatrix}$$

The transformation has decoupled the system (the matrix is diagonal), as claimed.

Solution in the canonical plane

$$\dot{z}_1 = -2z_1, \qquad \dot{z}_2 = -3z_2$$

Each equation is separable. If $z_i \neq 0$, $\frac{dz_i}{z_i} = \lambda_i\,dt$ and integrating, $\ln|z_i| = \lambda_i t + C_i$, so $z_i = c_i e^{\lambda_i t}$ with $c_i = \pm e^{C_i}$ (the solution $z_i \equiv 0$ corresponds to $c_i = 0$). Equivalently, $\frac{d}{dt}(e^{-\lambda_i t} z_i) = 0$.

$$z_1(t) = c_1 e^{-2t}, \qquad z_2(t) = c_2 e^{-3t}$$

Back to the original coordinates

$\mathbf{x} = Q\mathbf{z} = z_1\mathbf{v}_1 + z_2\mathbf{v}_2$, so the general solution is

$$\mathbf{x}(t) = c_1 e^{-2t}\begin{pmatrix}1\\2\end{pmatrix} + c_2 e^{-3t}\begin{pmatrix}2\\-3\end{pmatrix}$$

$$x(t) = c_1 e^{-2t} + 2c_2 e^{-3t}, \qquad y(t) = 2c_1 e^{-2t} - 3c_2 e^{-3t}$$

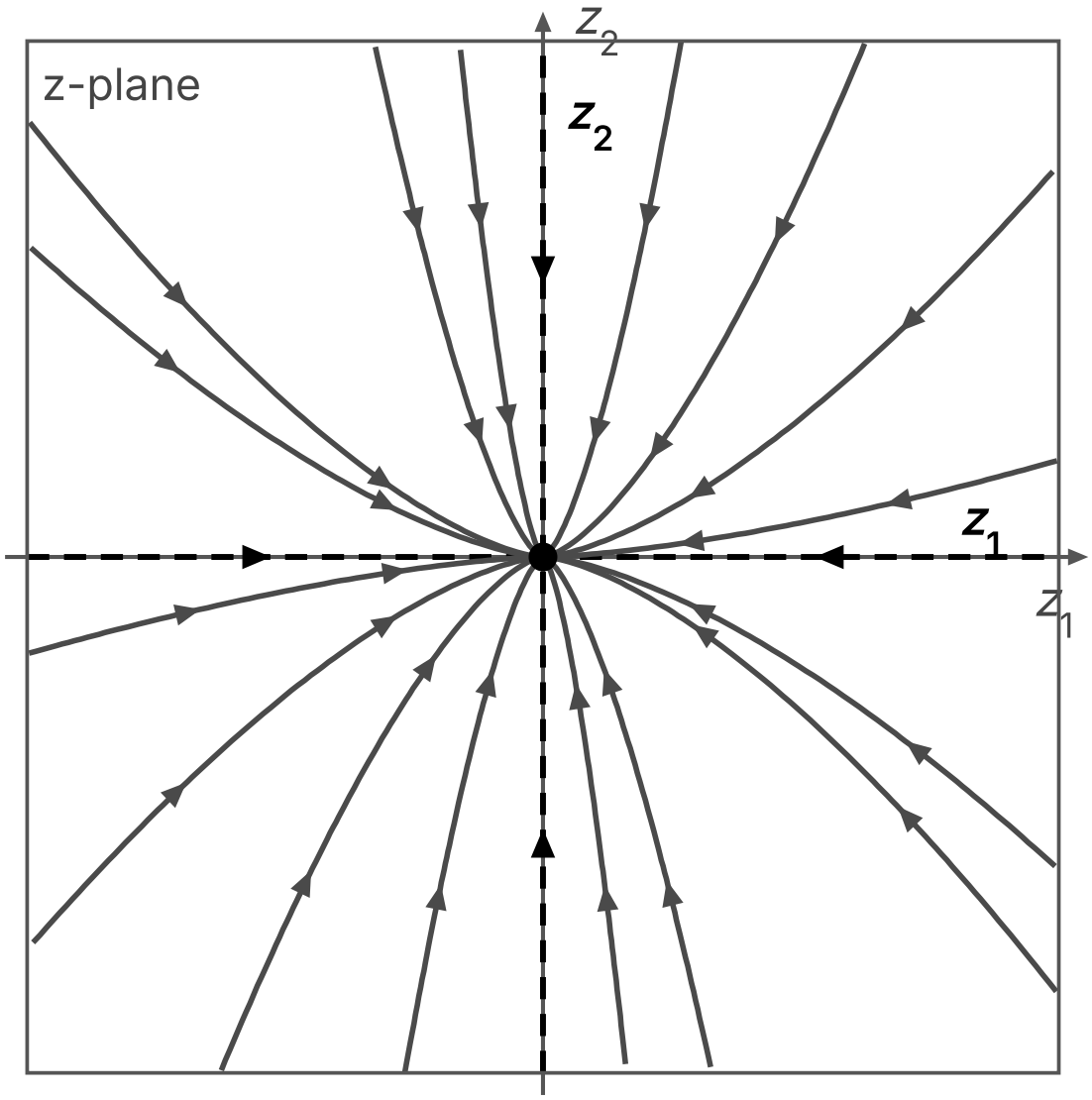
Phase portrait

$\lambda_1 = -2$ and $\lambda_2 = -3$ are both negative: the origin is a **stable node** (Robinson Ch. 28, Topic 4 Sec. 6 and 9).

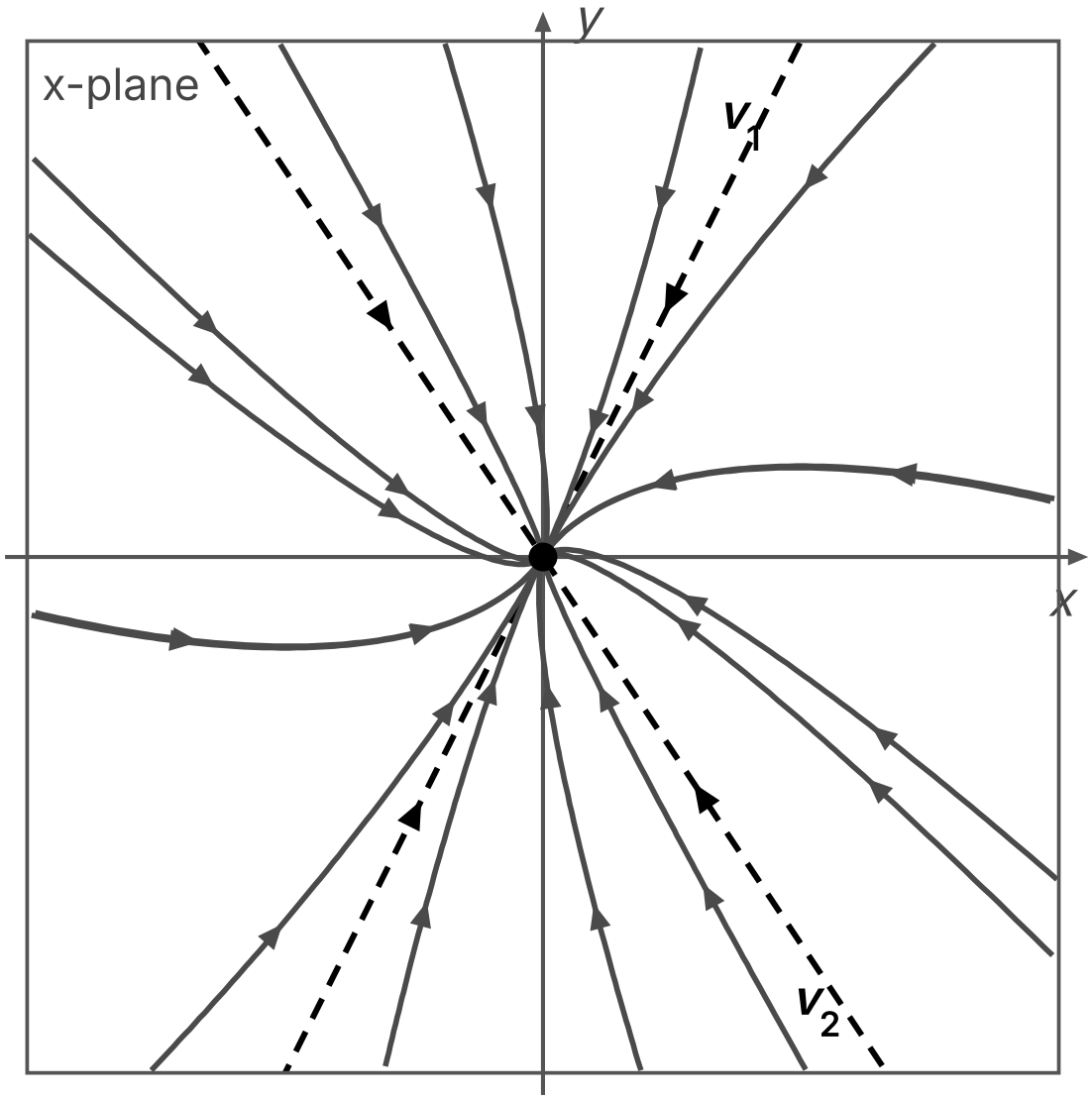
In the canonical $\mathbf{z}$-plane, eliminating t from $z_1 = c_1 e^{-2t}$ and $z_2 = c_2 e^{-3t}$ (for $c_1 \neq 0$): $|z_1|/|c_1| = e^{\lambda_1 t}$, so $e^t = (|z_1|/|c_1|)^{1/\lambda_1}$ and $|z_2| = |c_2| e^{\lambda_2 t} = |c_2|\,(|z_1|/|c_1|)^{\lambda_2/\lambda_1}$, i.e. $z_2 = K\,|z_1|^{\lambda_2/\lambda_1} = K\,|z_1|^{\frac{3}{2}}$ with $K = c_2 |c_1|^{-\lambda_2/\lambda_1}$ (equivalently, integrate the separable equation $\frac{dz_2}{dz_1} = \frac{\lambda_2 z_2}{\lambda_1 z_1}$ by the chain rule, as in Exercise 10). The axes $z_1 = 0$ and $z_2 = 0$ are invariant: a solution that starts on an axis stays on it.

The exponent $\lambda_2/\lambda_1 = \frac{3}{2}$ is positive, so the orbits are parabola-like curves through the origin. At the origin they are tangent to the eigenvector of the eigenvalue of **smaller modulus**, $|\lambda| = 2$, i.e. to the line through $(1, 2)$ (they arrive there as $t \to +\infty$), and far from the origin they become parallel to the other eigenvector (the fast direction). The arrows point towards the origin on both eigenlines.

The map $\mathbf{x} = Q\mathbf{z}$ sends the z_1-axis to the line through $\mathbf{v}_1 = (1, 2)$ and the z_2-axis to the line through $\mathbf{v}_2 = (2, -3)$. Straight lines stay straight and the origin stays fixed, so the $\mathbf{x}$-portrait is the canonical one sheared onto the eigenlines. On $\mathbf{v}_1$: $\dot{\mathbf{x}} = A\mathbf{v}_1 = -2\mathbf{v}_1$ points inward; on $\mathbf{v}_2$: $\dot{\mathbf{x}} = -3\mathbf{v}_2$ points inward.



Canonical $\mathbf{z}$-plane (stable node): invariant axes and orbits $z_2 = K|z_1|^{\frac{3}{2}}$.



Original (x, y)-plane (stable node): dashed lines are the eigenlines $\mathbf{v}_1 = (1, 2)$ and $\mathbf{v}_2 = (2, -3)$.

(iv) $\lambda_1 = 3,\ \mathbf{v}_1 = (2, 3)^T;\ \lambda_2 = -5,\ \mathbf{v}_2 = (0, 1)^T$

The statement gives the eigen-data, not the matrix. Since $A\mathbf{v}_j = \lambda_j \mathbf{v}_j$ for $j = 1, 2$ means $AQ = Q\Lambda$ with $Q = [\mathbf{v}_1 \mid \mathbf{v}_2]$, the matrix is $A = Q\Lambda Q^{-1}$ (it is needed to draw the portrait and to check the data):

$$Q = \begin{pmatrix} 2 & 0 \\ 3 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad \Lambda = \begin{pmatrix} 3 & 0 \\ 0 & -5 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad \det Q = 2, \qquad Q^{-1} = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{1}{2} & 0 \\ -\frac{3}{2} & 1 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$
\begin{aligned}
(Q\Lambda)_{11} &= 2\cdot 3 + 0\cdot 0 = 6\\
(Q\Lambda)_{12} &= 2\cdot 0 + 0\cdot(-5) = 0\\
(Q\Lambda)_{21} &= 3\cdot 3 + 1\cdot 0 = 9\\
(Q\Lambda)_{22} &= 3\cdot 0 + 1\cdot(-5) = -5
\end{aligned}
$$

$$
Q\Lambda = \begin{pmatrix} 6 & 0 \\ 9 & -5 \end{pmatrix}
$$

$$
\begin{aligned}
(A)_{11} &= 6\cdot\frac{1}{2} + 0\cdot(-\frac{3}{2}) = 3\\
(A)_{12} &= 6\cdot 0 + 0\cdot 1 = 0\\
(A)_{21} &= 9\cdot\frac{1}{2} + (-5)\cdot(-\frac{3}{2}) = 12\\
(A)_{22} &= 9\cdot 0 + (-5)\cdot 1 = -5
\end{aligned}
$$

$$
A = Q\Lambda Q^{-1} = \begin{pmatrix} 3 & 0 \\ 12 & -5 \end{pmatrix}
$$

Change of coordinates

The eigenvectors of distinct eigenvalues are linearly independent (Topic 4, Appendix B argument), so they form a basis. Put them as columns, $Q = [\mathbf{v}_1 \mid \mathbf{v}_2]$, and define the new coordinates by $\mathbf{z} = Q^{-1}\mathbf{x}$, i.e. $\mathbf{x} = Q\mathbf{z}$:

$$
Q = \begin{pmatrix} 2 & 0 \\ 3 & 1 \end{pmatrix}
$$

$\det Q = (2)(1) - (0)(3) = 2$, which is not zero, so Q is invertible. For a 2×2 matrix $\begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix}^{-1} = \frac{1}{ad-bc}\begin{pmatrix} d & -b \\ -c & a \end{pmatrix}$ (Robinson, Appendix B):

$$
Q^{-1} = \frac{1}{2}\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ -3 & 2 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{1}{2} & 0 \\ -\frac{3}{2} & 1 \end{pmatrix}
$$

Since Q is constant, $\dot{\mathbf{z}} = Q^{-1}\dot{\mathbf{x}} = Q^{-1}A\mathbf{x} = (Q^{-1}AQ)\mathbf{z}$. Compute AQ one column at a time, with $A\mathbf{v}_j = \lambda_j\mathbf{v}_j$:

$$A\mathbf{v}_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 3 & 0 \\ 12 & -5 \end{pmatrix}\begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 3 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 6 \\ 9 \end{pmatrix} = 3\mathbf{v}_1, \qquad A\mathbf{v}_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 3 & 0 \\ 12 & -5 \end{pmatrix}\begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ -5 \end{pmatrix} = (-5)\mathbf{v}_2$$

$$AQ = [A\mathbf{v}_1 \mid A\mathbf{v}_2] = \begin{pmatrix} 6 & 0 \\ 9 & -5 \end{pmatrix}$$

Now multiply by Q^{-1} on the left, entry by entry:

$$\begin{aligned} (Q^{-1}AQ)_{11} &= \frac{1}{2}\cdot 6 + 0 \cdot 9 = 3 \\ (Q^{-1}AQ)_{12} &= \frac{1}{2}\cdot 0 + 0 \cdot (-5) = 0 \\ (Q^{-1}AQ)_{21} &= (-\frac{3}{2})\cdot 6 + 1 \cdot 9 = 0 \\ (Q^{-1}AQ)_{22} &= (-\frac{3}{2})\cdot 0 + 1 \cdot (-5) = -5 \end{aligned}$$

$$Q^{-1}AQ = \begin{pmatrix} 3 & 0 \\ 0 & -5 \end{pmatrix} = \Lambda = \begin{pmatrix} 3 & 0 \\ 0 & -5 \end{pmatrix}$$

The transformation has decoupled the system (the matrix is diagonal), as claimed.

Solution in the canonical plane

$$\dot{z}_1 = 3z_1, \qquad \dot{z}_2 = -5z_2$$

Each equation is separable. If $z_i \neq 0$, $\frac{dz_i}{z_i} = \lambda_i\, dt$ and integrating, $\ln|z_i| = \lambda_i t + C_i$, so $z_i = c_i e^{\lambda_i t}$ with $c_i = \pm e^{C_i}$ (the solution $z_i \equiv 0$ corresponds to $c_i = 0$). Equivalently, $\frac{d}{dt}(e^{-\lambda_i t} z_i) = 0$.

$$z_1(t) = c_1 e^{3t}, \qquad z_2(t) = c_2 e^{-5t}$$

Back to the original coordinates

$\mathbf{x} = Q\mathbf{z} = z_1\mathbf{v}_1 + z_2\mathbf{v}_2$, so the general solution is

$$\mathbf{x}(t) = c_1 e^{3t}\begin{pmatrix}2\\3\end{pmatrix} + c_2 e^{-5t}\begin{pmatrix}0\\1\end{pmatrix}$$

$$x(t) = 2c_1 e^{3t}, \qquad y(t) = 3c_1 e^{3t} + c_2 e^{-5t}$$

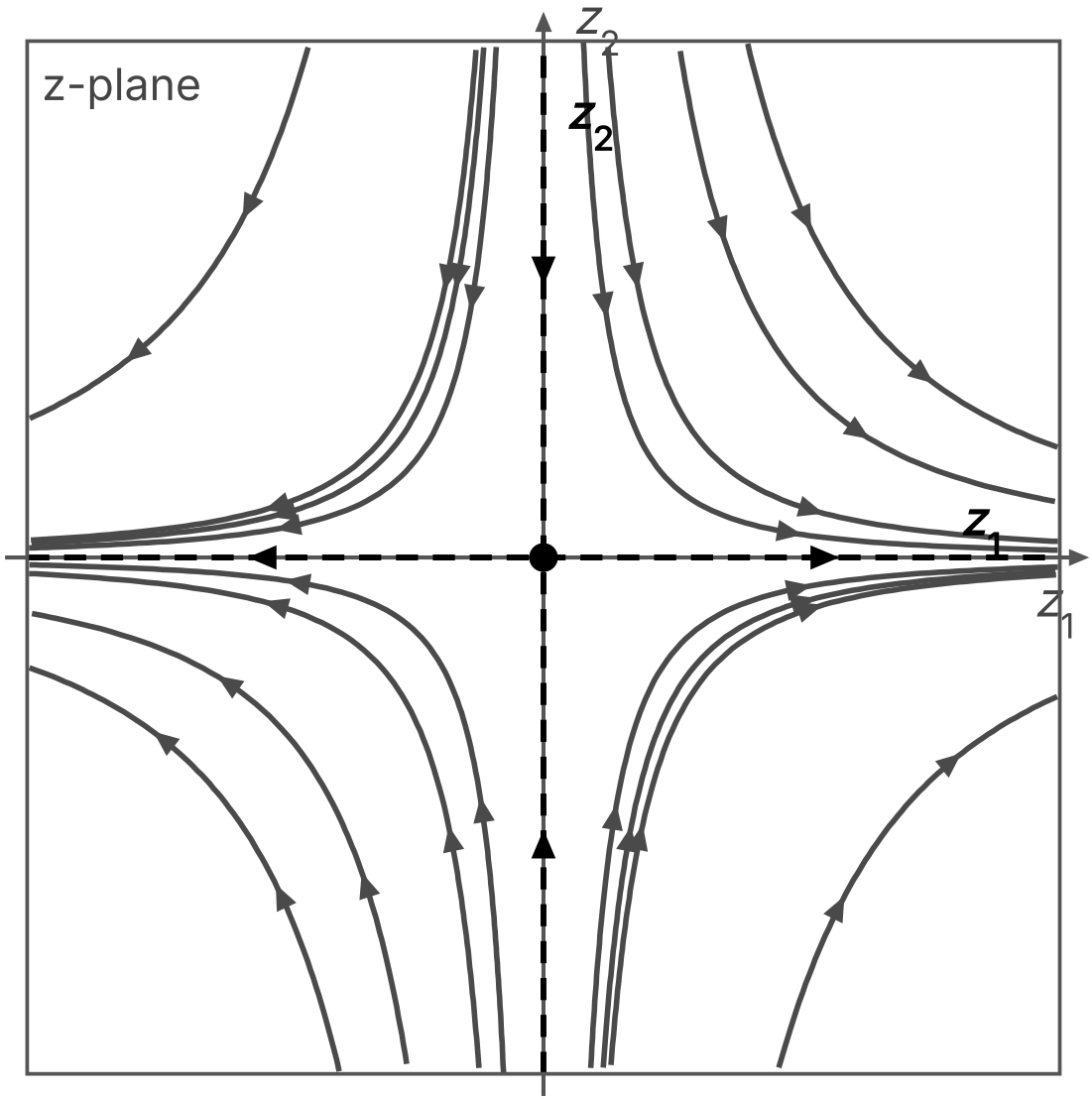
Phase portrait

$\lambda_1 = 3$ and $\lambda_2 = -5$ are of opposite signs: the origin is a **saddle** (Robinson Ch. 28, Topic 4 Sec. 6 and 9).

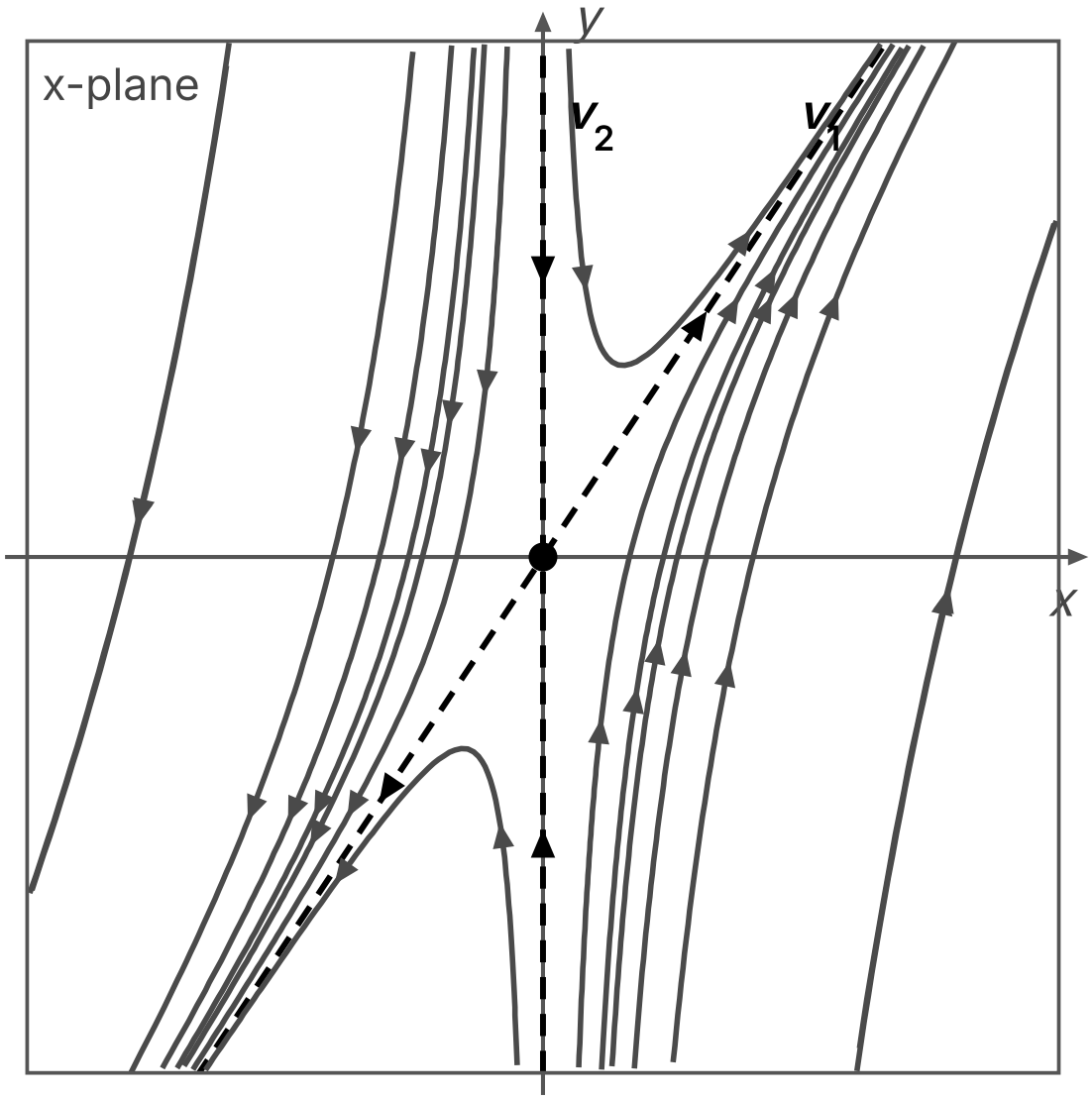
In the canonical $\mathbf{z}$-plane, eliminating t from $z_1 = c_1 e^{3t}$ and $z_2 = c_2 e^{-5t}$ (for $c_1 \neq 0$): $|z_1|/|c_1| = e^{\lambda_1 t}$, so $e^t = (|z_1|/|c_1|)^{1/\lambda_1}$ and $|z_2| = |c_2| e^{\lambda_2 t} = |c_2|\,(|z_1|/|c_1|)^{\lambda_2/\lambda_1}$, i.e. $z_2 = K\,|z_1|^{\lambda_2/\lambda_1} = K\,|z_1|^{-\frac{5}{3}}$ with $K = c_2 |c_1|^{-\lambda_2/\lambda_1}$ (equivalently, integrate the separable equation $\frac{dz_2}{dz_1} = \frac{\lambda_2 z_2}{\lambda_1 z_1}$ by the chain rule, as in Exercise 10). The axes $z_1 = 0$ and $z_2 = 0$ are invariant: a solution that starts on an axis stays on it.

The exponent $\lambda_2/\lambda_1 = -\frac{5}{3}$ is negative, so the orbits are hyperbola-like. Only solutions starting on the eigenline of the negative eigenvalue, the line through $(0,1)$ (the **stable manifold**), reach the origin as $t \to +\infty$; the line through $(2,3)$ (positive eigenvalue) is the **unstable manifold**. All other orbits come in close to the stable line, then leave along the unstable one.

The map $\mathbf{x} = Q\mathbf{z}$ sends the z_1-axis to the line through $\mathbf{v}_1 = (2,3)$ and the z_2-axis to the line through $\mathbf{v}_2 = (0,1)$. Straight lines stay straight and the origin stays fixed, so the $\mathbf{x}$-portrait is the canonical one sheared onto the eigenlines. On $\mathbf{v}_1$: $\dot{\mathbf{x}} = A\mathbf{v}_1 = 3\mathbf{v}_1$ points outward; on $\mathbf{v}_2$: $\dot{\mathbf{x}} = -5\mathbf{v}_2$ points inward.



Canonical $\mathbf{z}$-plane (saddle): invariant axes and orbits $z_2 = K|z_1|^{-\frac{5}{3}}$.



Original (x, y)-plane (saddle): dashed lines are the eigenlines $\mathbf{v}_1 = (2, 3)$ and $\mathbf{v}_2 = (0, 1)$.

(v) $\lambda_1 = 3,\ \mathbf{v}_1 = (1, 2)^T;\ \lambda_2 = 1,\ \mathbf{v}_2 = (1, -3)^T$

The statement gives the eigen-data, not the matrix. Since $A\mathbf{v}_j = \lambda_j \mathbf{v}_j$ for $j = 1, 2$ means $AQ = Q\Lambda$ with $Q = [\mathbf{v}_1 \mid \mathbf{v}_2]$, the matrix is $A = Q\Lambda Q^{-1}$ (it is needed to draw the portrait and to check the data):

$$Q = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 2 & -3 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad \Lambda = \begin{pmatrix} 3 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad \det Q = -5, \qquad Q^{-1} = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{3}{5} & \frac{1}{5} \\ \frac{2}{5} & -\frac{1}{5} \end{pmatrix}$$

$$
\begin{aligned}
(Q\Lambda)_{11} &= 1\cdot 3 + 1\cdot 0 = 3\\
(Q\Lambda)_{12} &= 1\cdot 0 + 1\cdot 1 = 1\\
(Q\Lambda)_{21} &= 2\cdot 3 + (-3)\cdot 0 = 6\\
(Q\Lambda)_{22} &= 2\cdot 0 + (-3)\cdot 1 = -3
\end{aligned}
$$

$$
Q\Lambda = \begin{pmatrix} 3 & 1 \\ 6 & -3 \end{pmatrix}
$$

$$
\begin{aligned}
(A)_{11} &= 3\cdot \frac{3}{5} + 1\cdot \frac{2}{5} = \frac{11}{5}\\
(A)_{12} &= 3\cdot \frac{1}{5} + 1\cdot (-\frac{1}{5}) = \frac{2}{5}\\
(A)_{21} &= 6\cdot \frac{3}{5} + (-3)\cdot \frac{2}{5} = \frac{12}{5}\\
(A)_{22} &= 6\cdot \frac{1}{5} + (-3)\cdot (-\frac{1}{5}) = \frac{9}{5}
\end{aligned}
$$

$$
A = Q\Lambda Q^{-1} = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{11}{5} & \frac{2}{5} \\ \frac{12}{5} & \frac{9}{5} \end{pmatrix}
$$

Change of coordinates

The eigenvectors of distinct eigenvalues are linearly independent (Topic 4, Appendix B argument), so they form a basis. Put them as columns, $Q = [\mathbf{v}_1 \mid \mathbf{v}_2]$, and define the new coordinates by $\mathbf{z} = Q^{-1}\mathbf{x}$, i.e. $\mathbf{x} = Q\mathbf{z}$:

$$
Q = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 2 & -3 \end{pmatrix}
$$

$\det Q = (1)(-3) - (1)(2) = -5$, which is not zero, so Q is invertible. For a 2×2 matrix $\begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix}^{-1} = \frac{1}{ad-bc}\begin{pmatrix} d & -b \\ -c & a \end{pmatrix}$ (Robinson, Appendix B):

$$
Q^{-1} = \frac{1}{-5}\begin{pmatrix} -3 & -1 \\ -2 & 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{3}{5} & \frac{1}{5} \\ \frac{2}{5} & -\frac{1}{5} \end{pmatrix}
$$

Since Q is constant, $\dot{\mathbf{z}} = Q^{-1}\dot{\mathbf{x}} = Q^{-1}A\mathbf{x} = (Q^{-1}AQ)\mathbf{z}$. Compute AQ one column at a time, with $A\mathbf{v}_j = \lambda_j \mathbf{v}_j$:

$$A\mathbf{v}_1 = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{11}{5} & \frac{2}{5} \\ \frac{12}{5} & \frac{8}{5} \end{pmatrix}\begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 3 \\ 6 \end{pmatrix} = 3\mathbf{v}_1, \qquad A\mathbf{v}_2 = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{11}{5} & \frac{2}{5} \\ \frac{12}{5} & \frac{8}{5} \end{pmatrix}\begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ -3 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ -3 \end{pmatrix} = 1\mathbf{v}_2$$

$$AQ = [A\mathbf{v}_1 \mid A\mathbf{v}_2] = \begin{pmatrix} 3 & 1 \\ 6 & -3 \end{pmatrix}$$

Now multiply by Q^{-1} on the left, entry by entry:

$$\begin{aligned} (Q^{-1}AQ)_{11} &= \frac{3}{5}\cdot 3 + \frac{1}{5}\cdot 6 = 3 \\ (Q^{-1}AQ)_{12} &= \frac{3}{5}\cdot 1 + \frac{1}{5}\cdot (-3) = 0 \\ (Q^{-1}AQ)_{21} &= \frac{2}{5}\cdot 3 + (-\frac{1}{5})\cdot 6 = 0 \\ (Q^{-1}AQ)_{22} &= \frac{2}{5}\cdot 1 + (-\frac{1}{5})\cdot (-3) = 1 \end{aligned}$$

$$Q^{-1}AQ = \begin{pmatrix} 3 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} = \Lambda = \begin{pmatrix} 3 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$$

The transformation has decoupled the system (the matrix is diagonal), as claimed.

Solution in the canonical plane

$$\dot{z}_1 = 3z_1, \qquad \dot{z}_2 = z_2$$

Each equation is separable. If $z_i \neq 0$, $\frac{dz_i}{z_i} = \lambda_i\,dt$ and integrating, $\ln|z_i| = \lambda_i t + C_i$, so $z_i = c_i e^{\lambda_i t}$ with $c_i = \pm e^{C_i}$ (the solution $z_i \equiv 0$ corresponds to $c_i = 0$). Equivalently, $\frac{d}{dt}(e^{-\lambda_i t} z_i) = 0$.

$$z_1(t) = c_1 e^{3t}, \qquad z_2(t) = c_2 e^{1t}$$

Back to the original coordinates

$\mathbf{x} = Q\mathbf{z} = z_1\mathbf{v}_1 + z_2\mathbf{v}_2$, so the general solution is

$$\mathbf{x}(t) = c_1 e^{3t}\begin{pmatrix}1\\2\end{pmatrix} + c_2 e^{1t}\begin{pmatrix}1\\-3\end{pmatrix}$$

$$x(t) = c_1 e^{3t} + c_2 e^{t}, \qquad y(t) = 2c_1 e^{3t} - 3c_2 e^{t}$$

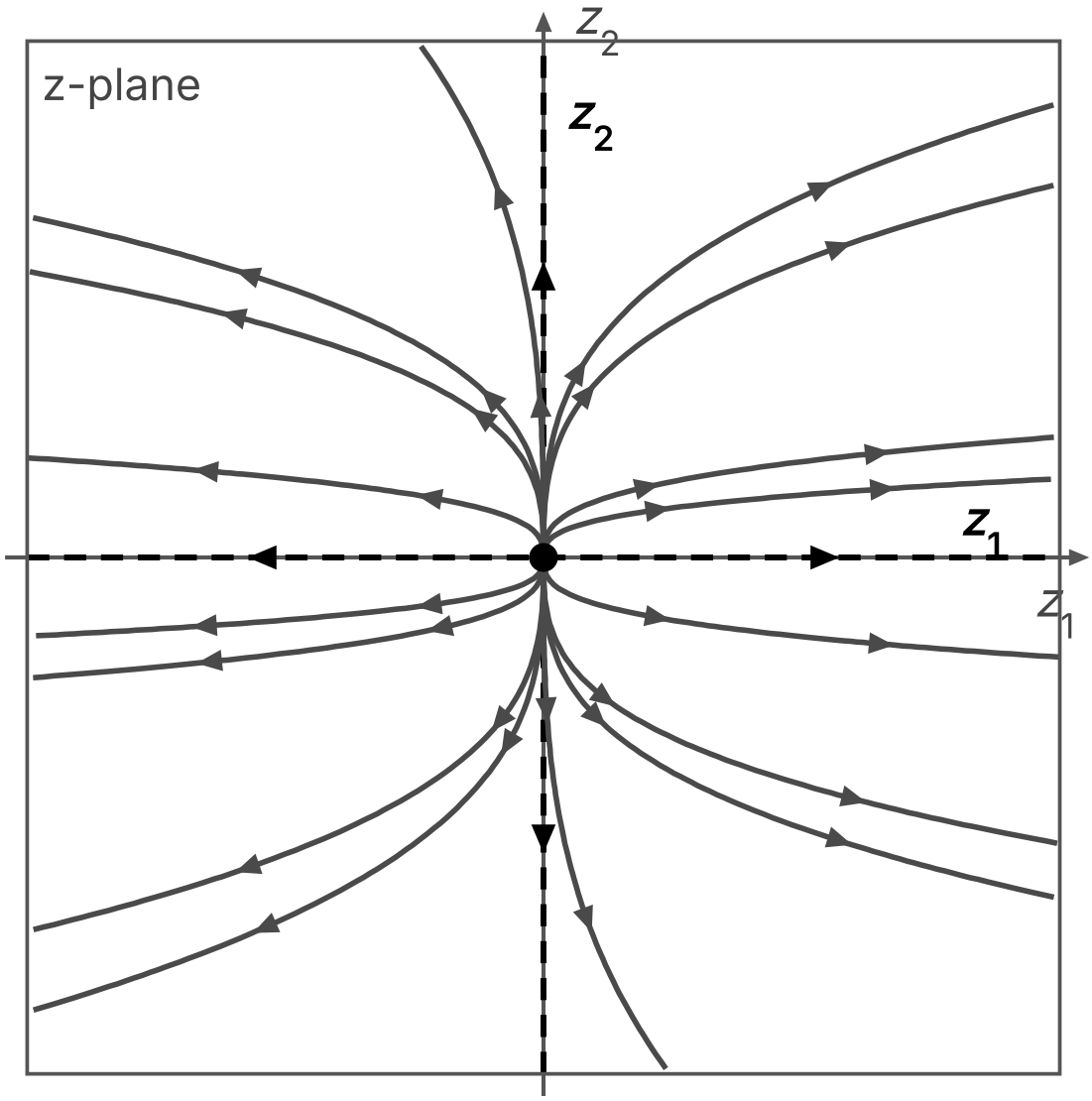
Phase portrait

$\lambda_1 = 3$ and $\lambda_2 = 1$ are both positive: the origin is a **unstable node** (Robinson Ch. 28, Topic 4 Sec. 6 and 9).

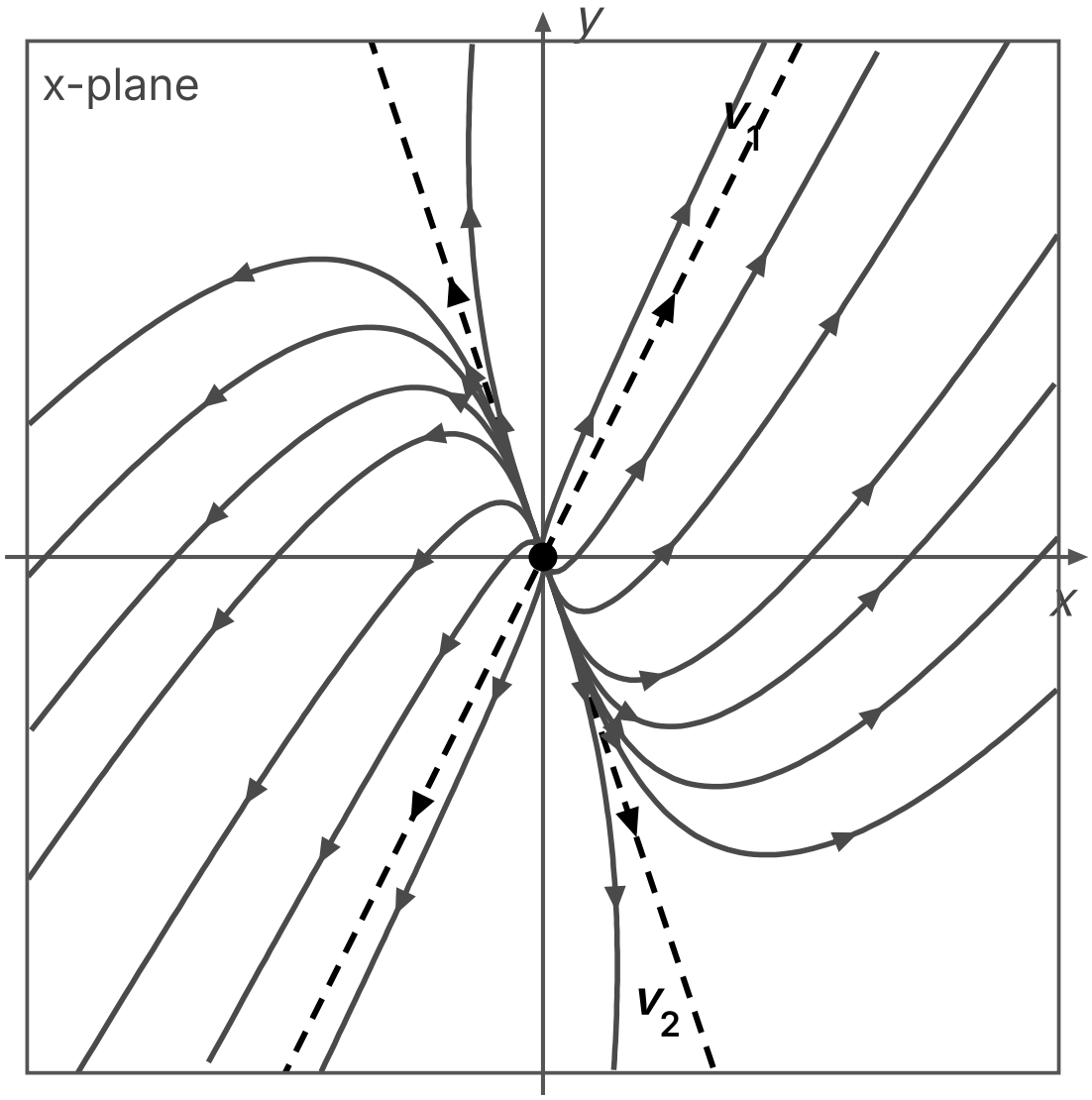
In the canonical $\mathbf{z}$-plane, eliminating t from $z_1 = c_1 e^{3t}$ and $z_2 = c_2 e^{1t}$ (for $c_1 \neq 0$): $|z_1|/|c_1| = e^{\lambda_1 t}$, so $e^t = (|z_1|/|c_1|)^{1/\lambda_1}$ and $|z_2| = |c_2| e^{\lambda_2 t} = |c_2|\,(|z_1|/|c_1|)^{\lambda_2/\lambda_1}$, i.e. $z_2 = K\,|z_1|^{\lambda_2/\lambda_1} = K\,|z_1|^{\frac{1}{3}}$ with $K = c_2 |c_1|^{-\lambda_2/\lambda_1}$ (equivalently, integrate the separable equation $\frac{dz_2}{dz_1} = \frac{\lambda_2 z_2}{\lambda_1 z_1}$ by the chain rule, as in Exercise 10). The axes $z_1 = 0$ and $z_2 = 0$ are invariant: a solution that starts on an axis stays on it.

The exponent $\lambda_2/\lambda_1 = \frac{1}{3}$ is positive, so the orbits are parabola-like curves through the origin. At the origin they are tangent to the eigenvector of the eigenvalue of **smaller modulus**, $|\lambda| = 1$, i.e. to the line through $(1, -3)$ (they leave from there (the limit $t \to -\infty$)), and far from the origin they become parallel to the other eigenvector (the fast direction). The arrows point away from the origin on both eigenlines.

The map $\mathbf{x} = Q\mathbf{z}$ sends the z_1-axis to the line through $\mathbf{v}_1 = (1, 2)$ and the z_2-axis to the line through $\mathbf{v}_2 = (1, -3)$. Straight lines stay straight and the origin stays fixed, so the $\mathbf{x}$-portrait is the canonical one sheared onto the eigenlines. On $\mathbf{v}_1$: $\dot{\mathbf{x}} = A\mathbf{v}_1 = 3\mathbf{v}_1$ points outward; on $\mathbf{v}_2$: $\dot{\mathbf{x}} = 1\mathbf{v}_2$ points outward.



Canonical $\mathbf{z}$-plane (unstable node): invariant axes and orbits $z_2 = K|z_1|^{\frac{1}{3}}$.



Original (x, y)-plane (unstable node): dashed lines are the eigenlines $\mathbf{v}_1 = (1, 2)$ and $\mathbf{v}_2 = (1, -3)$.

(vi) $\lambda_1 = 2$, $\mathbf{v}_1 = (0, 1)^T$; $\lambda_2 = -3$, $\mathbf{v}_2 = (1, 5)^T$

The statement gives the eigen-data, not the matrix. Since $A\mathbf{v}_j = \lambda_j \mathbf{v}_j$ for $j = 1, 2$ means $AQ = Q\Lambda$ with $Q = [\mathbf{v}_1 \mid \mathbf{v}_2]$, the matrix is $A = Q\Lambda Q^{-1}$ (it is needed to draw the portrait and to check the data):

$$Q = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 5 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad \Lambda = \begin{pmatrix} 2 & 0 \\ 0 & -3 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad \det Q = -1, \qquad Q^{-1} = \begin{pmatrix} -5 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$
\begin{aligned}
(Q\Lambda)_{11} &= 0 \cdot 2 + 1 \cdot 0 = 0 \\
(Q\Lambda)_{12} &= 0 \cdot 0 + 1 \cdot (-3) = -3 \\
(Q\Lambda)_{21} &= 1 \cdot 2 + 5 \cdot 0 = 2 \\
(Q\Lambda)_{22} &= 1 \cdot 0 + 5 \cdot (-3) = -15
\end{aligned}
$$

$$
Q\Lambda = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & -3 \\ 2 & -15 \end{pmatrix}
$$

$$
\begin{aligned}
(A)_{11} &= 0 \cdot (-5) + (-3) \cdot 1 = -3 \\
(A)_{12} &= 0 \cdot 1 + (-3) \cdot 0 = 0 \\
(A)_{21} &= 2 \cdot (-5) + (-15) \cdot 1 = -25 \\
(A)_{22} &= 2 \cdot 1 + (-15) \cdot 0 = 2
\end{aligned}
$$

$$
A = Q\Lambda Q^{-1} = \begin{pmatrix} -3 & 0 \\ -25 & 2 \end{pmatrix}
$$

Change of coordinates

The eigenvectors of distinct eigenvalues are linearly independent (Topic 4, Appendix B argument), so they form a basis. Put them as columns, $Q = [\mathbf{v}_1 \mid \mathbf{v}_2]$, and define the new coordinates by $\mathbf{z} = Q^{-1}\mathbf{x}$, i.e. $\mathbf{x} = Q\mathbf{z}$:

$$
Q = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 5 \end{pmatrix}
$$

$\det Q = (0)(5) - (1)(1) = -1$, which is not zero, so Q is invertible. For a 2×2 matrix $\begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix}^{-1} = \frac{1}{ad-bc}\begin{pmatrix} d & -b \\ -c & a \end{pmatrix}$ (Robinson, Appendix B):

$$
Q^{-1} = \frac{1}{-1}\begin{pmatrix} 5 & -1 \\ -1 & 0 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} -5 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}
$$

Since Q is constant, $\dot{\mathbf{z}} = Q^{-1}\dot{\mathbf{x}} = Q^{-1}A\mathbf{x} = (Q^{-1}AQ)\mathbf{z}$. Compute AQ one column at a time, with $A\mathbf{v}_j = \lambda_j \mathbf{v}_j$:

$$A\mathbf{v}_1 = \begin{pmatrix} -3 & 0 \\ -25 & 2 \end{pmatrix}\begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix} = 2\mathbf{v}_1, \qquad A\mathbf{v}_2 = \begin{pmatrix} -3 & 0 \\ -25 & 2 \end{pmatrix}\begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 5 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} -3 \\ -15 \end{pmatrix} = (-3)\mathbf{v}_2$$

$$AQ = [A\mathbf{v}_1 \mid A\mathbf{v}_2] = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & -3 \\ 2 & -15 \end{pmatrix}$$

Now multiply by Q^{-1} on the left, entry by entry:

$$\begin{aligned} (Q^{-1}AQ)_{11} &= (-5)\cdot 0 + 1 \cdot 2 = 2 \\ (Q^{-1}AQ)_{12} &= (-5)\cdot(-3) + 1 \cdot (-15) = 0 \\ (Q^{-1}AQ)_{21} &= 1 \cdot 0 + 0 \cdot 2 = 0 \\ (Q^{-1}AQ)_{22} &= 1 \cdot (-3) + 0 \cdot (-15) = -3 \end{aligned}$$

$$Q^{-1}AQ = \begin{pmatrix} 2 & 0 \\ 0 & -3 \end{pmatrix} = \Lambda = \begin{pmatrix} 2 & 0 \\ 0 & -3 \end{pmatrix}$$

The transformation has decoupled the system (the matrix is diagonal), as claimed.

Solution in the canonical plane

$$\dot{z}_1 = 2z_1, \qquad \dot{z}_2 = -3z_2$$

Each equation is separable. If $z_i \neq 0$, $\frac{dz_i}{z_i} = \lambda_i\,dt$ and integrating, $\ln|z_i| = \lambda_i t + C_i$, so $z_i = c_i e^{\lambda_i t}$ with $c_i = \pm e^{C_i}$ (the solution $z_i \equiv 0$ corresponds to $c_i = 0$). Equivalently, $\frac{d}{dt}(e^{-\lambda_i t} z_i) = 0$.

$$z_1(t) = c_1 e^{2t}, \qquad z_2(t) = c_2 e^{-3t}$$

Back to the original coordinates

$\mathbf{x} = Q\mathbf{z} = z_1\mathbf{v}_1 + z_2\mathbf{v}_2$, so the general solution is

$$\mathbf{x}(t) = c_1 e^{2t}\begin{pmatrix}0\\1\end{pmatrix} + c_2 e^{-3t}\begin{pmatrix}1\\5\end{pmatrix}$$

$$x(t) = c_2 e^{-3t}, \qquad y(t) = c_1 e^{2t} + 5c_2 e^{-3t}$$

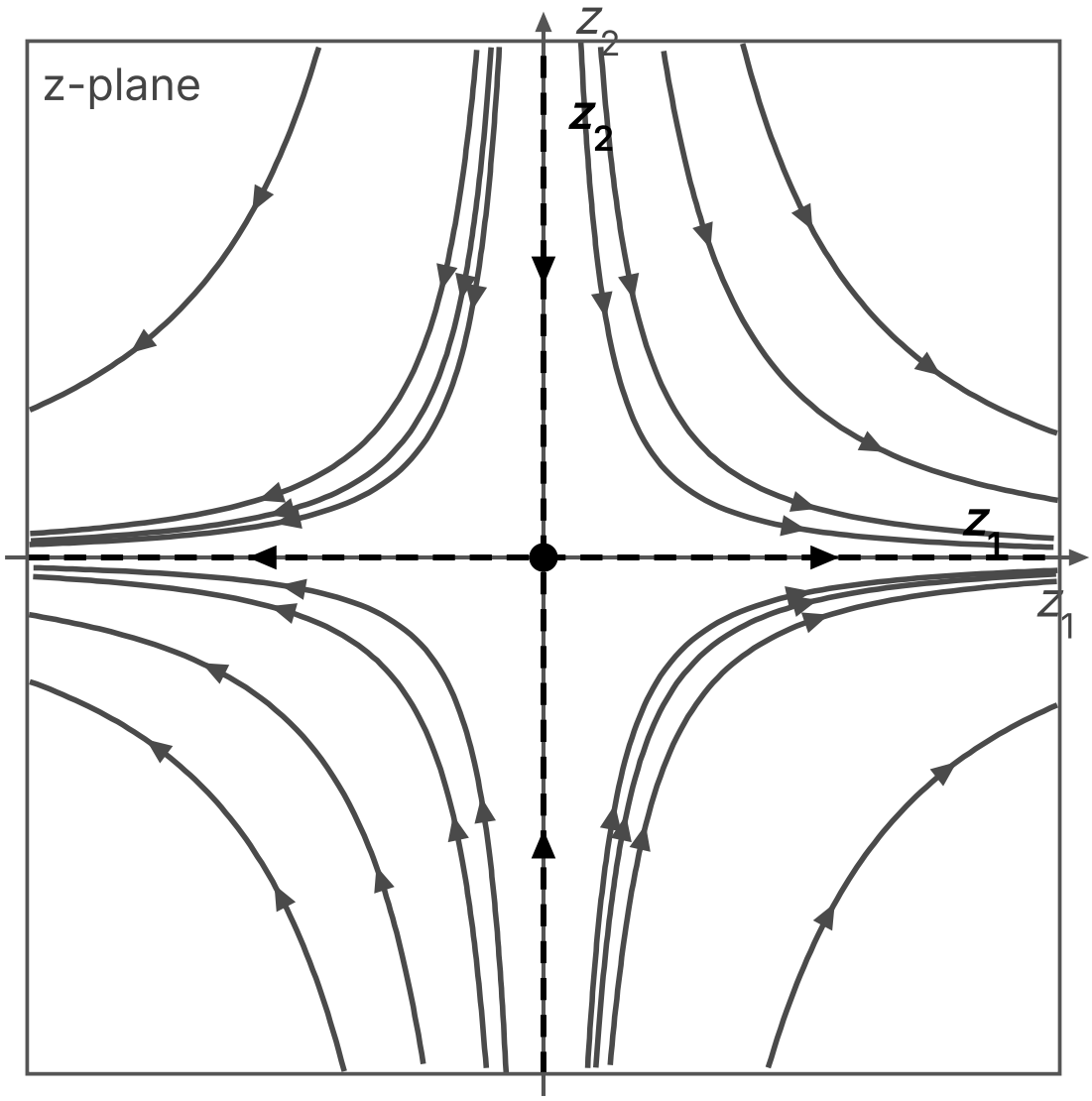
Phase portrait

$\lambda_1 = 2$ and $\lambda_2 = -3$ are of opposite signs: the origin is a **saddle** (Robinson Ch. 28, Topic 4 Sec. 6 and 9).

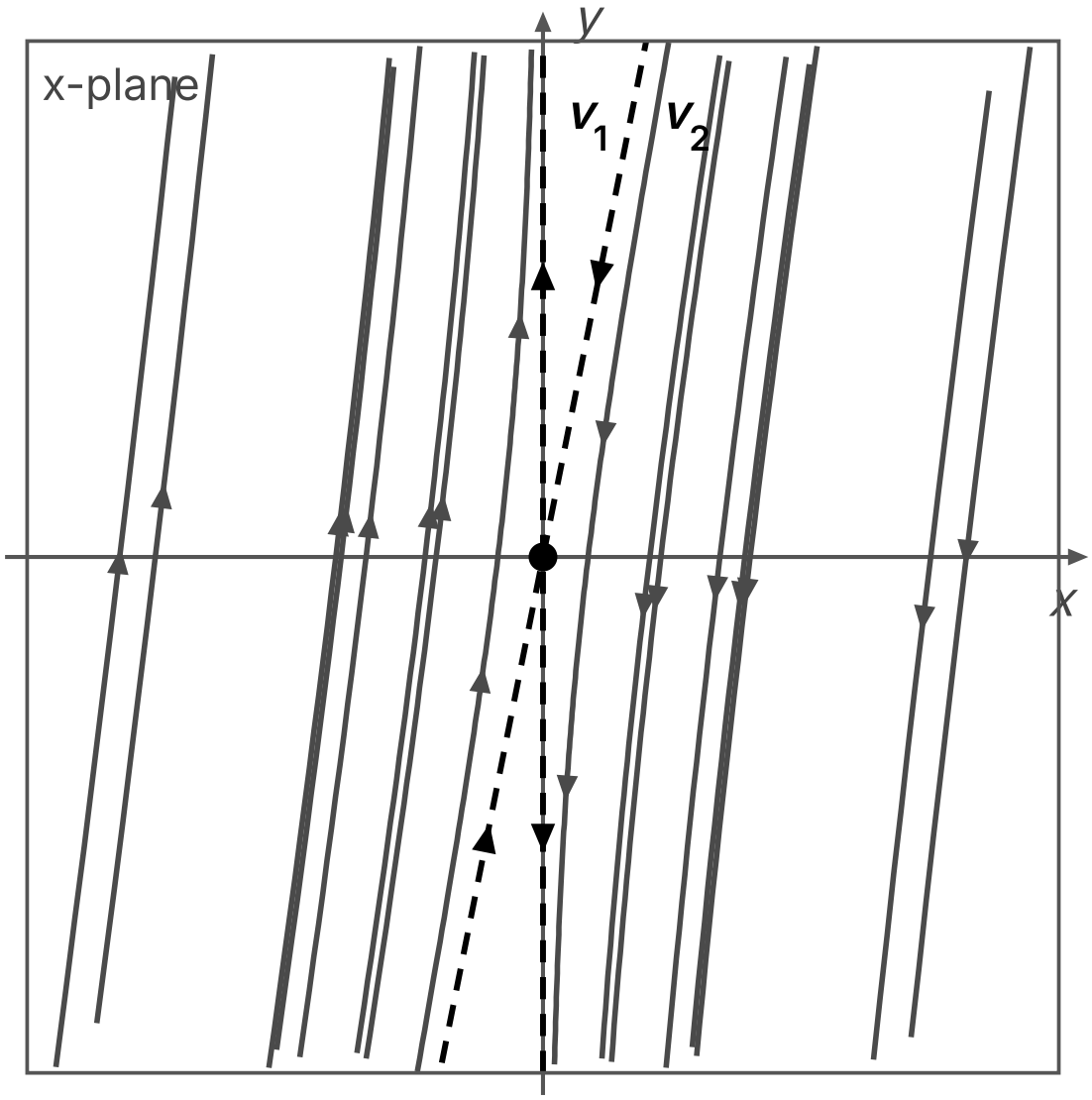
In the canonical $\mathbf{z}$-plane, eliminating t from $z_1 = c_1 e^{2t}$ and $z_2 = c_2 e^{-3t}$ (for $c_1 \neq 0$): $|z_1|/|c_1| = e^{\lambda_1 t}$, so $e^t = (|z_1|/|c_1|)^{1/\lambda_1}$ and $|z_2| = |c_2| e^{\lambda_2 t} = |c_2|\,(|z_1|/|c_1|)^{\lambda_2/\lambda_1}$, i.e. $z_2 = K\,|z_1|^{\lambda_2/\lambda_1} = K\,|z_1|^{-\frac{3}{2}}$ with $K = c_2 |c_1|^{-\lambda_2/\lambda_1}$ (equivalently, integrate the separable equation $\frac{dz_2}{dz_1} = \frac{\lambda_2 z_2}{\lambda_1 z_1}$ by the chain rule, as in Exercise 10). The axes $z_1 = 0$ and $z_2 = 0$ are invariant: a solution that starts on an axis stays on it.

The exponent $\lambda_2/\lambda_1 = -\frac{3}{2}$ is negative, so the orbits are hyperbola-like. Only solutions starting on the eigenline of the negative eigenvalue, the line through $(1, 5)$ (the **stable manifold**), reach the origin as $t \to +\infty$; the line through $(0, 1)$ (positive eigenvalue) is the **unstable manifold**. All other orbits come in close to the stable line, then leave along the unstable one.

The map $\mathbf{x} = Q\mathbf{z}$ sends the z_1-axis to the line through $\mathbf{v}_1 = (0, 1)$ and the z_2-axis to the line through $\mathbf{v}_2 = (1, 5)$. Straight lines stay straight and the origin stays fixed, so the $\mathbf{x}$-portrait is the canonical one sheared onto the eigenlines. On $\mathbf{v}_1$: $\dot{\mathbf{x}} = A\mathbf{v}_1 = 2\mathbf{v}_1$ points outward; on $\mathbf{v}_2$: $\dot{\mathbf{x}} = -3\mathbf{v}_2$ points inward.



Canonical $\mathbf{z}$-plane (saddle): invariant axes and orbits $z_2 = K|z_1|^{-\frac{3}{2}}$.



Original (x, y)-plane (saddle): dashed lines are the eigenlines $\mathbf{v}_1 = (0, 1)$ and $\mathbf{v}_2 = (1, 5)$.

(vii) $\lambda_1 = 1,\ \mathbf{v}_1 = (1, 1)^T;\ \lambda_2 = 2,\ \mathbf{v}_2 = (2, 1)^T$

The statement gives the eigen-data, not the matrix. Since $A\mathbf{v}_j = \lambda_j \mathbf{v}_j$ for $j = 1, 2$ means $AQ = Q\Lambda$ with $Q = [\mathbf{v}_1 \mid \mathbf{v}_2]$, the matrix is $A = Q\Lambda Q^{-1}$ (it is needed to draw the portrait and to check the data):

$$Q = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad \Lambda = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 2 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad \det Q = -1, \qquad Q^{-1} = \begin{pmatrix} -1 & 2 \\ 1 & -1 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$
\begin{aligned}
(Q\Lambda)_{11} &= 1\cdot 1 + 2\cdot 0 = 1\\
(Q\Lambda)_{12} &= 1\cdot 0 + 2\cdot 2 = 4\\
(Q\Lambda)_{21} &= 1\cdot 1 + 1\cdot 0 = 1\\
(Q\Lambda)_{22} &= 1\cdot 0 + 1\cdot 2 = 2
\end{aligned}
$$

$$
Q\Lambda = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 4 \\ 1 & 2 \end{pmatrix}
$$

$$
\begin{aligned}
(A)_{11} &= 1\cdot(-1) + 4\cdot 1 = 3\\
(A)_{12} &= 1\cdot 2 + 4\cdot(-1) = -2\\
(A)_{21} &= 1\cdot(-1) + 2\cdot 1 = 1\\
(A)_{22} &= 1\cdot 2 + 2\cdot(-1) = 0
\end{aligned}
$$

$$
A = Q\Lambda Q^{-1} = \begin{pmatrix} 3 & -2 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}
$$

Change of coordinates

The eigenvectors of distinct eigenvalues are linearly independent (Topic 4, Appendix B argument), so they form a basis. Put them as columns, $Q = [\mathbf{v}_1 \mid \mathbf{v}_2]$, and define the new coordinates by $\mathbf{z} = Q^{-1}\mathbf{x}$, i.e. $\mathbf{x} = Q\mathbf{z}$:

$$
Q = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix}
$$

$\det Q = (1)(1) - (2)(1) = -1$, which is not zero, so Q is invertible. For a 2×2 matrix $\begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix}^{-1} = \frac{1}{ad-bc}\begin{pmatrix} d & -b \\ -c & a \end{pmatrix}$ (Robinson, Appendix B):

$$
Q^{-1} = \frac{1}{-1}\begin{pmatrix} 1 & -2 \\ -1 & 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} -1 & 2 \\ 1 & -1 \end{pmatrix}
$$

Since Q is constant, $\dot{\mathbf{z}} = Q^{-1}\dot{\mathbf{x}} = Q^{-1}A\mathbf{x} = (Q^{-1}AQ)\mathbf{z}$. Compute AQ one column at a time, with $A\mathbf{v}_j = \lambda_j \mathbf{v}_j$:

$$A\mathbf{v}_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 3 & -2 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}\begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} = 1\mathbf{v}_1, \qquad A\mathbf{v}_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 3 & -2 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}\begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 4 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix} = 2\mathbf{v}_2$$

$$AQ = [A\mathbf{v}_1 \mid A\mathbf{v}_2] = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 4 \\ 1 & 2 \end{pmatrix}$$

Now multiply by Q^{-1} on the left, entry by entry:

$$\begin{aligned} (Q^{-1}AQ)_{11} &= (-1)\cdot 1 + 2 \cdot 1 = 1 \\ (Q^{-1}AQ)_{12} &= (-1)\cdot 4 + 2 \cdot 2 = 0 \\ (Q^{-1}AQ)_{21} &= 1\cdot 1 + (-1) \cdot 1 = 0 \\ (Q^{-1}AQ)_{22} &= 1\cdot 4 + (-1) \cdot 2 = 2 \end{aligned}$$

$$Q^{-1}AQ = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 2 \end{pmatrix} = \Lambda = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 2 \end{pmatrix}$$

The transformation has decoupled the system (the matrix is diagonal), as claimed.

Solution in the canonical plane

$$\dot{z}_1 = z_1, \qquad \dot{z}_2 = 2z_2$$

Each equation is separable. If $z_i \neq 0$, $\frac{dz_i}{z_i} = \lambda_i\, dt$ and integrating, $\ln|z_i| = \lambda_i t + C_i$, so $z_i = c_i e^{\lambda_i t}$ with $c_i = \pm e^{C_i}$ (the solution $z_i \equiv 0$ corresponds to $c_i = 0$). Equivalently, $\frac{d}{dt}(e^{-\lambda_i t} z_i) = 0$.

$$z_1(t) = c_1 e^{1t}, \qquad z_2(t) = c_2 e^{2t}$$

Back to the original coordinates

$\mathbf{x} = Q\mathbf{z} = z_1\mathbf{v}_1 + z_2\mathbf{v}_2$, so the general solution is

$$\mathbf{x}(t) = c_1 e^{1t}\begin{pmatrix}1\\1\end{pmatrix} + c_2 e^{2t}\begin{pmatrix}2\\1\end{pmatrix}$$

$$x(t) = c_1 e^{t} + 2c_2 e^{2t}, \qquad y(t) = c_1 e^{t} + c_2 e^{2t}$$

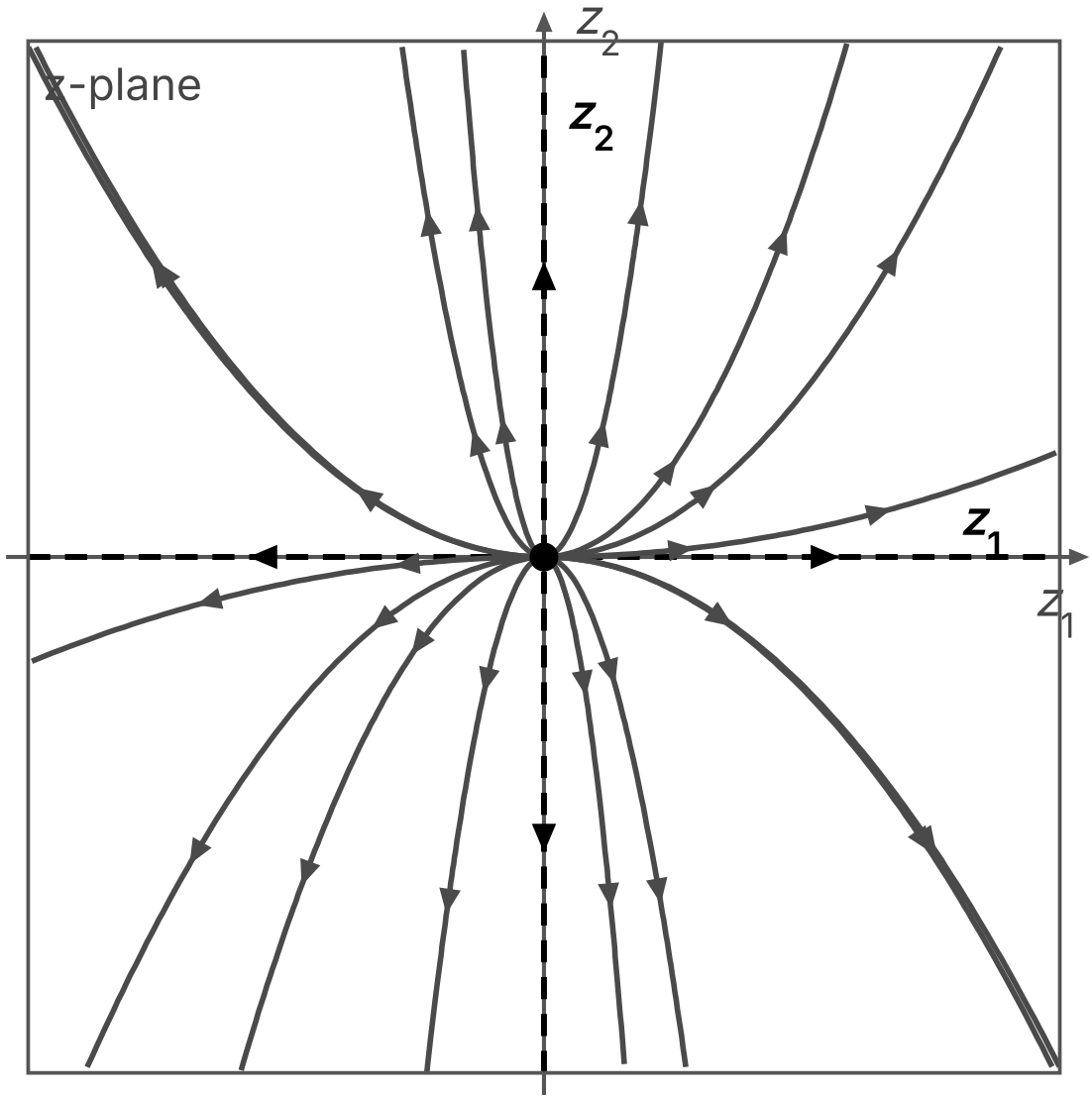
Phase portrait

$\lambda_1 = 1$ and $\lambda_2 = 2$ are both positive: the origin is a **unstable node** (Robinson Ch. 28, Topic 4 Sec. 6 and 9).

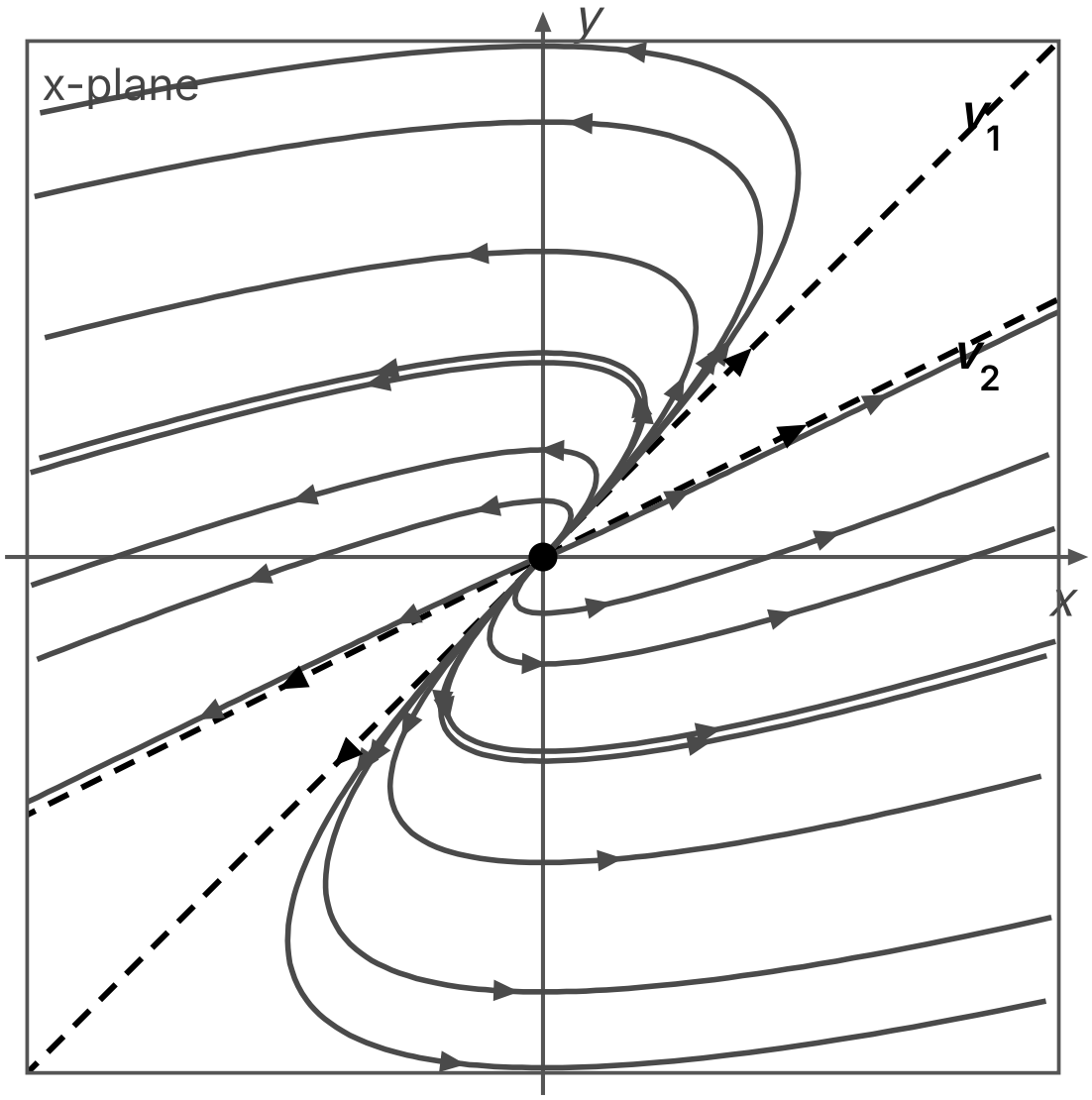
In the canonical $\mathbf{z}$-plane, eliminating t from $z_1 = c_1 e^{1t}$ and $z_2 = c_2 e^{2t}$ (for $c_1 \neq 0$): $|z_1|/|c_1| = e^{\lambda_1 t}$, so $e^t = (|z_1|/|c_1|)^{1/\lambda_1}$ and $|z_2| = |c_2| e^{\lambda_2 t} = |c_2|\,(|z_1|/|c_1|)^{\lambda_2/\lambda_1}$, i.e. $z_2 = K\,|z_1|^{\lambda_2/\lambda_1} = K\,|z_1|^2$ with $K = c_2 |c_1|^{-\lambda_2/\lambda_1}$ (equivalently, integrate the separable equation $\frac{dz_2}{dz_1} = \frac{\lambda_2 z_2}{\lambda_1 z_1}$ by the chain rule, as in Exercise 10). The axes $z_1 = 0$ and $z_2 = 0$ are invariant: a solution that starts on an axis stays on it.

The exponent $\lambda_2/\lambda_1 = 2$ is positive, so the orbits are parabola-like curves through the origin. At the origin they are tangent to the eigenvector of the eigenvalue of **smaller modulus**, $|\lambda| = 1$, i.e. to the line through $(1, 1)$ (they leave from there (the limit $t \to -\infty$)), and far from the origin they become parallel to the other eigenvector (the fast direction). The arrows point away from the origin on both eigenlines.

The map $\mathbf{x} = Q\mathbf{z}$ sends the z_1-axis to the line through $\mathbf{v}_1 = (1, 1)$ and the z_2-axis to the line through $\mathbf{v}_2 = (2, 1)$. Straight lines stay straight and the origin stays fixed, so the $\mathbf{x}$-portrait is the canonical one sheared onto the eigenlines. On $\mathbf{v}_1$: $\dot{\mathbf{x}} = A\mathbf{v}_1 = 1\mathbf{v}_1$ points outward; on $\mathbf{v}_2$: $\dot{\mathbf{x}} = 2\mathbf{v}_2$ points outward.



Canonical $\mathbf{z}$-plane (unstable node): invariant axes and orbits $z_2 = K|z_1|^2$.



Original (x, y)-plane (unstable node): dashed lines are the eigenlines $\mathbf{v}_1 = (1, 1)$ and $\mathbf{v}_2 = (2, 1)$.

(viii) $\lambda_1 = -3,\ \mathbf{v}_1 = (1, 3)^T;\ \lambda_2 = -1,\ \mathbf{v}_2 = (-3, 2)^T$

The statement gives the eigen-data, not the matrix. Since $A\mathbf{v}_j = \lambda_j \mathbf{v}_j$ for $j = 1, 2$ means $AQ = Q\Lambda$ with $Q = [\mathbf{v}_1 \mid \mathbf{v}_2]$, the matrix is $A = Q\Lambda Q^{-1}$ (it is needed to draw the portrait and to check the data):

$$Q = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & -3 \\ 3 & 2 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad \Lambda = \begin{pmatrix} -3 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad \det Q = 11, \qquad Q^{-1} = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{2}{11} & \frac{3}{11} \\ -\frac{3}{11} & \frac{1}{11} \end{pmatrix}$$

$$
\begin{aligned}
(Q\Lambda)_{11} &= 1\cdot(-3) + (-3)\cdot 0 = -3 \\
(Q\Lambda)_{12} &= 1\cdot 0 + (-3)\cdot(-1) = 3 \\
(Q\Lambda)_{21} &= 3\cdot(-3) + 2\cdot 0 = -9 \\
(Q\Lambda)_{22} &= 3\cdot 0 + 2\cdot(-1) = -2
\end{aligned}
$$

$$
Q\Lambda = \begin{pmatrix} -3 & 3 \\ -9 & -2 \end{pmatrix}
$$

$$
\begin{aligned}
(A)_{11} &= (-3)\cdot\frac{2}{11} + 3\cdot(-\frac{3}{11}) = -\frac{15}{11} \\
(A)_{12} &= (-3)\cdot\frac{3}{11} + 3\cdot\frac{1}{11} = -\frac{6}{11} \\
(A)_{21} &= (-9)\cdot\frac{2}{11} + (-2)\cdot(-\frac{3}{11}) = -\frac{12}{11} \\
(A)_{22} &= (-9)\cdot\frac{3}{11} + (-2)\cdot\frac{1}{11} = -\frac{29}{11}
\end{aligned}
$$

$$
A = Q\Lambda Q^{-1} = \begin{pmatrix} -\frac{15}{11} & -\frac{6}{11} \\ -\frac{12}{11} & -\frac{29}{11} \end{pmatrix}
$$

Change of coordinates

The eigenvectors of distinct eigenvalues are linearly independent (Topic 4, Appendix B argument), so they form a basis. Put them as columns, $Q = [\mathbf{v}_1 \mid \mathbf{v}_2]$, and define the new coordinates by $\mathbf{z} = Q^{-1}\mathbf{x}$, i.e. $\mathbf{x} = Q\mathbf{z}$:

$$
Q = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & -3 \\ 3 & 2 \end{pmatrix}
$$

$\det Q = (1)(2) - (-3)(3) = 11$, which is not zero, so Q is invertible. For a 2×2 matrix $\begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix}^{-1} = \frac{1}{ad-bc}\begin{pmatrix} d & -b \\ -c & a \end{pmatrix}$ (Robinson, Appendix B):

$$
Q^{-1} = \frac{1}{11}\begin{pmatrix} 2 & 3 \\ -3 & 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{2}{11} & \frac{3}{11} \\ -\frac{3}{11} & \frac{1}{11} \end{pmatrix}
$$

Since Q is constant, $\dot{\mathbf{z}} = Q^{-1}\dot{\mathbf{x}} = Q^{-1}A\mathbf{x} = (Q^{-1}AQ)\mathbf{z}$. Compute AQ one column at a time, with $A\mathbf{v}_j = \lambda_j\mathbf{v}_j$:

$$A\mathbf{v}_1 = \begin{pmatrix} -\frac{15}{11} & -\frac{6}{11} \\ -\frac{12}{11} & -\frac{29}{11} \end{pmatrix}\begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 3 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} -3 \\ -9 \end{pmatrix} = (-3)\mathbf{v}_1, \qquad A\mathbf{v}_2 = \begin{pmatrix} -\frac{15}{11} & -\frac{6}{11} \\ -\frac{12}{11} & -\frac{29}{11} \end{pmatrix}\begin{pmatrix} -3 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 3 \\ -2 \end{pmatrix} = (-1)\mathbf{v}_2$$

$$AQ = [A\mathbf{v}_1 \mid A\mathbf{v}_2] = \begin{pmatrix} -3 & 3 \\ -9 & -2 \end{pmatrix}$$

Now multiply by Q^{-1} on the left, entry by entry:

$$\begin{aligned} (Q^{-1}AQ)_{11} &= \frac{2}{11}\cdot(-3) + \frac{3}{11}\cdot(-9) = -3 \\ (Q^{-1}AQ)_{12} &= \frac{2}{11}\cdot 3 + \frac{3}{11}\cdot(-2) = 0 \\ (Q^{-1}AQ)_{21} &= (-\frac{3}{11})\cdot(-3) + \frac{1}{11}\cdot(-9) = 0 \\ (Q^{-1}AQ)_{22} &= (-\frac{3}{11})\cdot 3 + \frac{1}{11}\cdot(-2) = -1 \end{aligned}$$

$$Q^{-1}AQ = \begin{pmatrix} -3 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 \end{pmatrix} = \Lambda = \begin{pmatrix} -3 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 \end{pmatrix}$$

The transformation has decoupled the system (the matrix is diagonal), as claimed.

Solution in the canonical plane

$$\dot{z}_1 = -3z_1, \qquad \dot{z}_2 = -z_2$$

Each equation is separable. If $z_i \neq 0$, $\frac{dz_i}{z_i} = \lambda_i\,dt$ and integrating, $\ln|z_i| = \lambda_i t + C_i$, so $z_i = c_i e^{\lambda_i t}$ with $c_i = \pm e^{C_i}$ (the solution $z_i \equiv 0$ corresponds to $c_i = 0$). Equivalently, $\frac{d}{dt}(e^{-\lambda_i t} z_i) = 0$.

$$z_1(t) = c_1 e^{-3t}, \qquad z_2(t) = c_2 e^{-1t}$$

Back to the original coordinates

$\mathbf{x} = Q\mathbf{z} = z_1\mathbf{v}_1 + z_2\mathbf{v}_2$, so the general solution is

$$\mathbf{x}(t) = c_1 e^{-3t}\begin{pmatrix}1\\3\end{pmatrix} + c_2 e^{-1t}\begin{pmatrix}-3\\2\end{pmatrix}$$

$$x(t) = c_1 e^{-3t} - 3c_2 e^{-t}, \qquad y(t) = 3c_1 e^{-3t} + 2c_2 e^{-t}$$

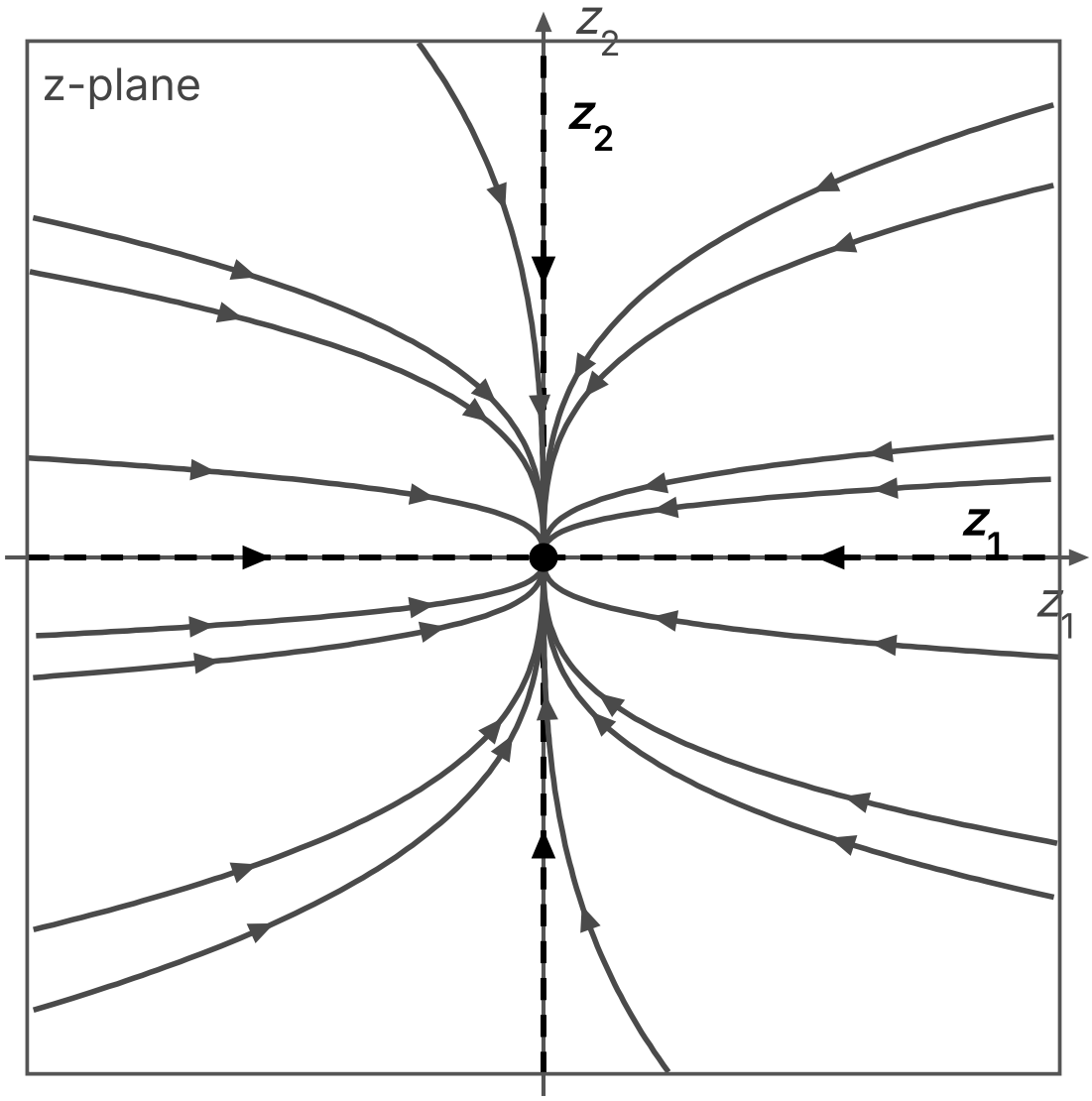
Phase portrait

$\lambda_1 = -3$ and $\lambda_2 = -1$ are both negative: the origin is a **stable node** (Robinson Ch. 28, Topic 4 Sec. 6 and 9).

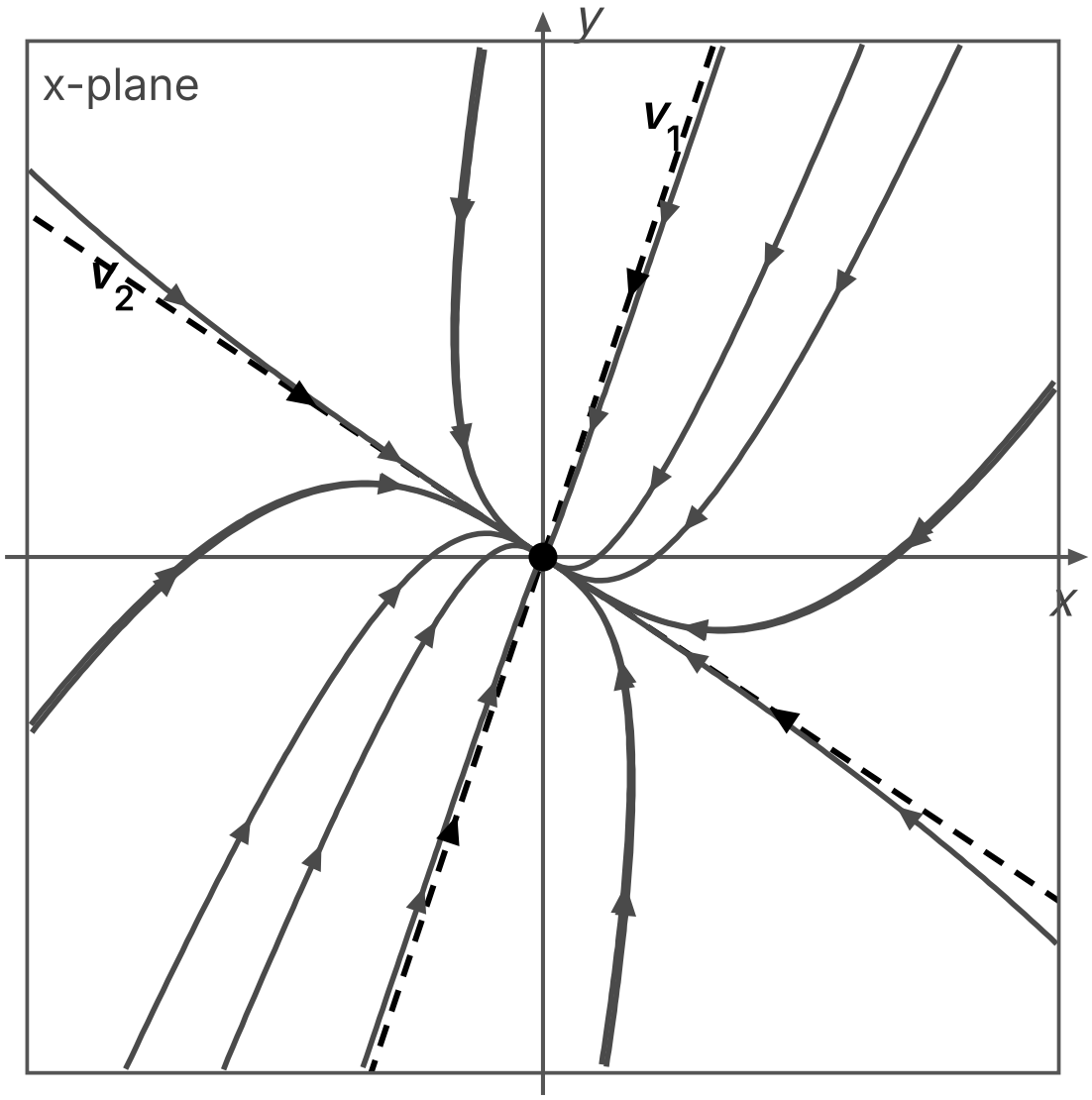
In the canonical $\mathbf{z}$-plane, eliminating t from $z_1 = c_1 e^{-3t}$ and $z_2 = c_2 e^{-1t}$ (for $c_1 \neq 0$): $|z_1|/|c_1| = e^{\lambda_1 t}$, so $e^t = (|z_1|/|c_1|)^{1/\lambda_1}$ and $|z_2| = |c_2| e^{\lambda_2 t} = |c_2|\,(|z_1|/|c_1|)^{\lambda_2/\lambda_1}$, i.e. $z_2 = K\,|z_1|^{\lambda_2/\lambda_1} = K\,|z_1|^{\frac{1}{3}}$ with $K = c_2 |c_1|^{-\lambda_2/\lambda_1}$ (equivalently, integrate the separable equation $\frac{dz_2}{dz_1} = \frac{\lambda_2 z_2}{\lambda_1 z_1}$ by the chain rule, as in Exercise 10). The axes $z_1 = 0$ and $z_2 = 0$ are invariant: a solution that starts on an axis stays on it.

The exponent $\lambda_2/\lambda_1 = \frac{1}{3}$ is positive, so the orbits are parabola-like curves through the origin. At the origin they are tangent to the eigenvector of the eigenvalue of **smaller modulus**, $|\lambda| = 1$, i.e. to the line through $(-3, 2)$ (they arrive there as $t \to +\infty$), and far from the origin they become parallel to the other eigenvector (the fast direction). The arrows point towards the origin on both eigenlines.

The map $\mathbf{x} = Q\mathbf{z}$ sends the z_1-axis to the line through $\mathbf{v}_1 = (1, 3)$ and the z_2-axis to the line through $\mathbf{v}_2 = (-3, 2)$. Straight lines stay straight and the origin stays fixed, so the $\mathbf{x}$-portrait is the canonical one sheared onto the eigenlines. On $\mathbf{v}_1$: $\dot{\mathbf{x}} = A\mathbf{v}_1 = -3\mathbf{v}_1$ points inward; on $\mathbf{v}_2$: $\dot{\mathbf{x}} = -1\mathbf{v}_2$ points inward.



Canonical $\mathbf{z}$-plane (stable node): invariant axes and orbits $z_2 = K|z_1|^{\frac{1}{3}}$.



Original (x, y)-plane (stable node): dashed lines are the eigenlines $\mathbf{v}_1 = (1, 3)$ and $\mathbf{v}_2 = (-3, 2)$.

PHASE 4: INTERPRETATION AND CHECKS

Item	General solution
(i)	$\mathbf{x} = c_1 e^{1t} \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} + c_2 e^{2t} \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ -1 \end{pmatrix}$
(ii)	$\mathbf{x} = c_1 e^{1t} \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} + c_2 e^{-2t} \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}$
(iii)	$\mathbf{x} = c_1 e^{-2t} \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix} + c_2 e^{-3t} \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ -3 \end{pmatrix}$
(iv)	$\mathbf{x} = c_1 e^{3t} \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 3 \end{pmatrix} + c_2 e^{-5t} \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}$

Item	General solution
(v)	$\mathbf{x} = c_1 e^{3t}\begin{pmatrix}1\\2\end{pmatrix} + c_2 e^{1t}\begin{pmatrix}1\\-3\end{pmatrix}$
(vi)	$\mathbf{x} = c_1 e^{2t}\begin{pmatrix}0\\1\end{pmatrix} + c_2 e^{-3t}\begin{pmatrix}1\\5\end{pmatrix}$
(vii)	$\mathbf{x} = c_1 e^{1t}\begin{pmatrix}1\\1\end{pmatrix} + c_2 e^{2t}\begin{pmatrix}2\\1\end{pmatrix}$
(viii)	$\mathbf{x} = c_1 e^{-3t}\begin{pmatrix}1\\3\end{pmatrix} + c_2 e^{-1t}\begin{pmatrix}-3\\2\end{pmatrix}$

- In every item the reconstructed A satisfies $A\mathbf{v}_j = \lambda_j \mathbf{v}_j$ (checked in the text) and $\det A = \lambda_1\lambda_2$, $\operatorname{tr} A = \lambda_1 + \lambda_2$.
- Nodes: the tangent direction at the origin is the eigenvector of the **smaller** $|\lambda|$ because $|z_2|/|z_1|^{\lambda_2/\lambda_1}$ is constant: if $|\lambda_2| > |\lambda_1|$ the exponent $r = \lambda_2/\lambda_1$ exceeds 1, so $z_2 = K|z_1|^r$ tends to 0 faster than z_1 and the curve hugs the z_1-axis (the slower eigendirection) near the origin; if $r < 1$ it hugs the z_2-axis, which is then the slower one. The phase portraits drawn above show this numerically (curves integrated from the matrix A itself, not from the formula, so the tangency is a genuine check).
- Saddles (ii), (iv), (vi): the stable manifold is the eigenline of the negative eigenvalue.
- Items (ii), (iv) and (vi) have an eigenvector with a zero entry ((ii) $\mathbf{v}_1 = (1,0)$, (iv) $\mathbf{v}_2 = (0,1)$, (vi) $\mathbf{v}_1 = (0,1)$): that eigenline is an axis of the (x,y)-plane.